ZIKSHARE LIBRARY
RENAISSANCE THEATRE

THOMAS HEYWOOD

A Woman Killed with Kindness

1603

Author	Thomas Heywood
Group	Thomas Heywood
Text	W. A. Neilson (ed.)
Source text	Project Gutenberg eBook #77587
Edition	The Chief Elizabethan Dramatists, excluding Shakespeare (1911)
Date	1603
Language	English
Rights	Public domain

This PDF was typeset by ZikShare from the edition named above.
The play is in the public domain and ZikShare charges nothing for it.
Project Gutenberg's header and licence, and its closing notice, are reproduced unchanged inside this file, because their terms travel with the text.
The first great English domestic tragedy, set in a country house rather than a court, with a subplot about a debtor who murders his enemy in a duel. Heywood claimed a hand in two hundred and twenty plays; this is the one that is still performed.

The Project Gutenberg eBook of The chief Elizabethan dramatists, excluding Shakespeare

This eBook is for the use of anyone anywhere in the United States and
most other parts of the world at no cost and with almost no restrictions
whatsoever. You may copy it, give it away or re-use it under the terms
of the Project Gutenberg License included with this eBook or online
at www.gutenberg.org. If you are not located in the United States,
you will have to check the laws of the country where you are located
before using this eBook.

Title: The chief Elizabethan dramatists, excluding Shakespeare
selected plays by Lyly, Peele, Greene, Marlowe, Kyd, Chapman, Jonson, Dekker, Marston, Heywood, Beaumont, Fletcher, Webster, Middleton, Massinger, Ford, Shirley

Editor: William Allan Neilson

Release date: December 31, 2025 [eBook #77587]

Language: English

Original publication: Boston: Houghton Mifflin, 1911

Other information and formats: www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/77587

Credits: Geetu Melwani, David Clarke, sounding92, Eleni Christofaki and the Online Distributed Proofreading Team at https://www.pgdp.net (This file was produced from images generously made available by The Internet Archive/Canadian Libraries)

*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK THE CHIEF ELIZABETHAN DRAMATISTS, EXCLUDING SHAKESPEARE ***
The edition's notes on this play's wording are gathered at the end of the text.

A WOMAN KILLED WITH KINDNESS

BY THOMAS HEYWOOD

[DRAMATIS PERSONAE

SIR FRANCIS ACTON, Brother to Mistress Frankford.
SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.
MASTER JOHN FRANKFORD.
MASTER MALBY, friend to Sir Francis.
MASTER WENDOLL, friend to Frankford.
MASTER CRANWELL.
MASTER SHAFTON, false friend to Sir Charles.
OLD MOUNTFORD, Uncle to Sir Charles.
MASTER SANDY.
MASTER RODER.
MASTER TIDY, Cousin to Sir Charles.
NICHOLAS, ROGER BRICKBAT, } Household Servants to
JENKIN, JACK SLIME, } Frankford.
SPIGOT, Butler, }
Sheriff.
Keeper of Prison.
Sheriff's Officers, Serjeant, Huntsmen, Falconers,
Coachmen, Carters, Servants, Musicians.

MISTRESS ANNE FRANKFORD.
SUSAN, Sister to Sir Charles Mountford.
CICELY, Maid to Mistress Frankford.
Women Servants in Master Frankford's household.]

PROLOGUE

I come but like a harbinger, being sent
To tell you what these preparations mean.
Look for no glorious state; our Muse is bent
Upon a barren subject, a bare scene.
We could afford this twig a timber-tree,
Whose strength might boldly on your favours build;
Our russet, tissue; drone, a honey-bee;
Our barren plot, a large and spacious field;
Our coarse fare, banquets; our thin water, wine;
Our brook, a sea; our bat's eyes, eagle's sight;
Our poet's dull and earthy Muse, divine;
Our ravens, doves; our crow's black feathers, white.
But gentle thoughts, when they may give the foil,[2802]
Save them that yield, and spare where they may spoil.

[ACT I]

[SCENE I.][2803]

Enter MASTER JOHN FRANKFORD, MISTRESS [FRANKFORD],[2804] SIR FRANCIS ACTON, SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD, MASTER MALBY, MASTER WENDOLL, AND MASTER CRANWELL.

Sir F. Some music, there! None lead the bride a dance?

Sir C. Yes, would she dance The Shaking of the Sheets;
But that's the dance her husband means to lead her.

Wen. That's not the dance that every man must dance,
According to the ballad.[2805]

Sir F. Music, ho!
By your leave, sister, - by your husband's leave,
I should have said, - the hand that but this day
Was given you in the church I'll borrow. - Sound!

This marriage music hoists me from the ground.

Frank. Ay, you may caper; you are light and free!
Marriage hath yok'd my heels; pray, then, pardon me.

Sir F. I'll have you dance too, brother!

Sir C. Master Frankford,
You are a happy man, sir, and much joy
Succeed your marriage mirth: you have a wife
So qualified, and with such ornaments
Both of the mind and body. First, her birth
Is noble, and her education such
As might become the daughter of a prince;
Her own tongue speaks all tongues, and her own hand
Can teach all strings to speak in their best grace,
From the shrill'st treble to the hoarsest base.
To end her many praises in one word,
She's Beauty and Perfection's eldest daughter,
Only found by yours, though many a heart hath sought her.

Frank. But that I know your virtues and chaste thoughts,
I should be jealous of your praise, Sir Charles.

Cran. He speaks no more than you approve.

Mal. Nor flatters he that gives to her her due.

Mrs. F. I would your praise could find a fitter theme
Than my imperfect beauties to speak on!
Such as they be, if they my husband please,
They suffice me now I am married.
His sweet content is like a flattering glass,
To make my face seem fairer to mine eye;
But the least wrinkle from his stormy brow
Will blast the roses in my cheeks that grow.

Sir F. A perfect wife already, meek and patient!
How strangely the word husband fits your mouth.
Not married three hours since! Sister, 't is good;
You that begin betimes thus must needs prove
Pliant and duteous in your husband's love. - Gramercies, brother! Wrought her to 't already, - 'Sweet husband,' and a curtsey, the first day?
Mark this, mark this, you that are bachelors,
And never took the grace[2806] of honest man;
Mark this, against you marry,[2807] this one phrase:
In a good time that man both wins and woos
That takes his wife down[2808] in her wedding shoes.

Frank. Your sister takes not after you, Sir Francis,
All his wild blood your father spent on you;
He got her in his age, when he grew civil.
All his mad tricks were to his land entail'd,
And you are heir to all; your sister, she
Hath to her dower her mother's modesty.

Sir C. Lord, sir, in what a happy state live you!
This morning, which to many seems a burden,
Too heavy to bear, is unto you a pleasure.
This lady is no clog, as many are;
She doth become you like a well-made suit,
In which the tailor hath us'd all his art;
Not like a thick coat of unseason'd frieze,
Forc'd on your back in summer. She's no chain
To tie your neck, and curb you to the yoke:
But she's a chain of gold to adorn your neck.
You both adorn each other, and your hands,
Methinks, are matches. There's equality
In this fair combination; you are both
Scholars, both young, both being descended nobly.
There's music in this sympathy; it carries
Consort and expectation of much joy,
Which God bestow on you from this first day
Until your dissolution, - that's for aye!

Sir F. We keep you here too long, good brother Frankford.
Into the hall; away! Go cheer your guests.
What! Bride and bridegroom both withdrawn at once?
If you be mist, the guests will doubt their welcome,
And charge you with unkindness.

Frank. To prevent it,
I'll leave you here, to see the dance within.

Mrs. F. And so will I.
Exeunt [MASTER AND MISTRESS FRANKFORD].

Sir. F. To part you it were sin. - Now, gallants, while the town musicians
Finger their frets[2809] within, and the mad lads
And country lasses, every mother's child,
With nosegays and bride-laces[2810] in their hats,
Dance all their country measures, rounds, and jigs,
What shall we do? Hark! They're all on the hoigh;[2811]
They toil like mill-horses, and turn as round, - Marry, not on the toe! Ay, and they caper,
[Not][2812] without cutting; you shall see, to-morrow,
The hall-floor peckt and dinted like a millstone,

Made with their high shoes. Though their skill be small,
Yet they tread heavy where their hobnails fall.

Sir C. Well, leave them to their sports! - Sir Francis Acton,
I'll make a match with you! Meet me to-morrow
At Chevy Chase; I'll fly my hawk with yours.

Sir F. For what? For what?

Sir C. Why, for a hundred pound.

Sir F. Pawn me some gold of that!

Sir C. Here are ten angels;[2813]
I'll make them good a hundred pound to-morrow
Upon my hawk's wing.

Sir. F. 'T is a match; 't is done.
Another hundred pound upon your dogs; - Dare ye, Sir Charles?

Sir C. I dare; were I sure to lose,
I durst do more than that; here is my hand,
The first course for a hundred pound!

Sir F. A match.

Wen. Ten angels on Sir Francis Acton's hawk;
As much upon his dogs!

Cran. I'm for Sir Charles Mountford: I have seen
His hawk and dog both tried. What! Clap ye hands,[2814]
Or is't no bargain?

Wen. Yes, and stake them down.
Were they five hundred, they were all my own.

Sir F. Be stirring early with the lark to-morrow;
I'll rise into my saddle ere the sun
Rise from his bed.

Sir C. If there you miss me, say
I am no gentleman! I'll hold my day.

Sir F. It holds on all sides. - Come, to-night let 's dance;
Early to-morrow let 's prepare to ride:
We 'd need be three hours up before the bride. Exeunt.

[SCENE II.][2815]

Enter NICHOLAS and JENKIN, JACK SLIME, ROGER BRICKBAT, with Country Wenches, and two or three Musicians.

Jen. Come, Nick, take you Joan Miniver, to trace withal; Jack Slime, traverse you with Cicely Milkpail; I will take Jane Trubkin, and Roger Brickbat shall have Isabel Motley. And now that they are busy in the parlour, come, strike up; we 'll have a crash[2816] here in the yard.

Nich. My humour is not compendious: dancing I possess not, though I can foot it; yet, since I am fallen into the hands of Cicely Milkpail, I consent.

Slime. Truly, Nick, though we were never brought up like serving courtiers, yet we have been brought up with serving creatures, - ay, and God's creatures, too; for we have been brought up to serve sheep, oxen, horses, hogs, and such like; and, though we be but country fellows, it may be in the way of dancing we can do the horse-trick as well as the serving-men.

Brick. Ay, and the cross-point too.

Jen. O Slime! O Brickbat! Do not you know that comparisons are odious? Now we are odious ourselves, too; therefore there are no comparisons to be made betwixt us.

Nich. I am sudden, and not superfluous;
I am quarrelsome, and not seditious;
I am peaceable, and not contentious;
I am brief, and not compendious.

Slime. Foot it quickly! If the music overcome not my melancholy, I shall quarrel; and if they suddenly do not strike up, I shall presently strike thee down.

Jen. No quarrelling, for God's sake! Truly, if you do, I shall set a knave between ye.

Slime. I come to dance, not to quarrel. Come, what shall it be? Rogero?[2817]

Jen. Rogero? No; we will dance The Beginning of the World.

Cicely. I love no dance so well as John come kiss me now.

Nich. I that have ere now deserv'd a cushion, call for the

Cushion-dance.

Brick. For my part, I like nothing so well as Tom Tyler.

Jen. No; we'll have The Hunting of the Fox.

Slime. The Hay, The Hay! There's nothing like The Hay.

Nich. I have said, I do say, and I will say again -

Jen. Every man agree to have it as Nick says!

All. Content.

Nich. It hath been, it now is, and it shall be - Cicely. What, Master Nicholas? What?

Nich. Put on your Smock a' Monday.

Jen. So the dance will come cleanly off! Come, for God's sake,
agree of something: if you like not that, put it to the musicians; or
let me speak for all, and we 'll have Sellenger's Round.

All. That, that, that!

Nich. No, I am resolv'd thus it shall be;
First take hands, then take ye to your heels.

Jen. Why, would you have us run away?

Nich. No; but I would have you shake your heels. - Music, strike up!

They dance; NICK dancing, speaks stately and scurvily, the rest
after the country fashion.

Jen. Hey! Lively, my lasses! Here's a turn for thee! Exeunt.

[SCENE III.][2818]

Wind horns. Enter SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD, SIR FRANCIS ACTON, MALBY,
CRANWELL, WENDOLL, Falconer, and Huntsmen.

Sir C. So; well cast off! Aloft, aloft! Well flown!
Oh, now she takes her at the souse,[2819] and strikes her
Down to the earth, like a swift thunder-clap.

Wen. She hath struck ten angels out of my way.

Sir F. A hundred pound from me.

Sir C. What, falconer!

Falc. At hand, sir!

Sir C. Now she hath seiz'd the fowl and 'gins to plume[2820] her,
Rebeck[2821] her not; rather stand still and check her!
So, seize her gets,[2822] her jesses,[2823] and her bells!
Away!

Sir F. My hawk kill'd, too.

Sir C. Ay, but 't was at the querre,[2824]
Not at the mount like mine.

Sir F. Judgment, my masters!

Cran. Yours mist her at the ferre.[2825]

Wen. Ay, but our merlin first had plum'd the fowl,
And twice renew'd[2826] her from the river too.
Her bells, Sir Francis, had not both one weight,
Nor was one semi-tune above the other.
Methinks, these Milan bells do sound too full,
And spoil the mounting of your hawk.

Sir C. 'T is lost.

Sir F. I grant it not. Mine likewise seiz'd a fowl
Within her talons, and you saw her paws
Full of the feathers: both her petty singles[2827]
And her long singles grip'd her more than other;
The terrials[2828] of her[2829] legs were stain'd with blood,
Not of the fowl only; she did discomfit
Some of her feathers; but she brake away.
Come, come; your hawk is but a rifler.[2830]

Sir C. How!

Sir F. Ay, and your dogs are trindle-tails[2831] and curs.

Sir C. You stir my blood.
You keep not one good hound in all your kennel.
Nor one good hawk upon your perch.

Sir F. How, knight!

Sir C. So, knight. You will not swagger, sir?

Sir F. Why, say I did?

Sir C. Why, sir,
I say you would gain as much by swagg'ring
As you have got by wagers on your dogs.
You will come short in all things.

Sir F. Not in this!
Now I'll strike home. [Strikes Sir Charles.]

Sir C. Thou shalt to thy long home,
Or I will want my will.

Sir F. All they that love Sir Francis, follow me!

Sir C. All that affect Sir Charles, draw on my part!

Cran. On this side heaves my hand.

Wen. Here goes my heart.

They divide themselves. SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD, CRANWELL, Falconer, and Huntsman, fight against SIR FRANCIS ACTON, WENDOLL, his Falconer and Huntsman; and SIR CHARLES hath the better, and beats them away, killing both of SIR FRANCIS'S men. [Exeunt all but SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD.]

Sir C. My God, what have I done! What have I done!
My rage hath plung'd into a sea of blood,
In which my soul lies drown'd. Poor innocents,
For whom we are to answer! Well, 't is done,
And I remain the victor. A great conquest,
When I would give this right hand, nay, this head,
To breathe in them new life whom I have slain! - Forgive me, God! 'T was in the heat of blood,
And anger quite removes me from myself.
It was not I, but rage, did this vile murder;
Yet I, and not my rage, must answer it.
Sir Francis Acton, he is fled the field;
With him all those that did partake his quarrel;
And I am left alone with sorrow dumb,
And in my height of conquest overcome.

Enter SUSAN.

Susan. O God! My brother wounded 'mong the dead!
Unhappy jest, that in such earnest ends!

The rumour of this fear stretcht to my ears,
And I am come to know if you be wounded.

Sir C. Oh, sister, sister! Wounded at the heart.

Susan. My God forbid!

Sir. C. In doing that thing which he forbad,
I am wounded, sister.

Susan. I hope, not at the heart.

Sir C. Yes, at the heart.

Susan. O God! A surgeon, there.

Sir C. Call me a surgeon, sister, for my soul!
The sin of murder, it hath pierc'd my heart
And made a wide wound there; but for these scratches,
They are nothing, nothing.

Susan. Charles, what have you done?
Sir Francis hath great friends, and will pursue you
Unto the utmost danger[2832] of the law.

Sir C. My conscience is become mine enemy,
And will pursue me more than Acton can.

Susan. Oh! Fly, sweet brother!

Sir C. Shall I fly from thee?
Why, Sue, art weary of my company?

Susan. Fly from your foe!

Sir C. You, sister, are my friend,
And flying you, I shall pursue my end.

Susan. Your company is as my eyeball dear;
Being far from you, no comfort can be near.
Yet fly to save your life! What would I care
To spend my future age in black despair,
So you were safe? And yet to live one week
Without my brother Charles, through every cheek
My streaming tears would downwards run so rank,[2833]
Till they could set on either side a bank,
And in the midst a channel; so my face
For two salt-water brooks shall still find place.

Sir C. Thou shalt not weep so much; for I will stay,
In spite of danger's teeth. I'll live with thee,
Or I'll not live at all. I will not sell
My country and my father's patrimony,
Nor thy sweet sight, for a vain hope of life.

Enter Sheriff, with Officers.

Sher. Sir Charles, I am made the unwilling instrument
Of your attach[2834] and apprehension.
I'm sorry that the blood of innocent men
Should be of you exacted. It was told me
That you were guarded with a troop of friends,
And therefore I come thus arm'd.

Sir C. Oh, Master Sheriff!
I came into the field with many friends,
But see, they all have left me; only one
Clings to my sad misfortune, my dear sister.
I know you for an honest gentleman;
I yield my weapons, and submit to you.
Convey me where you please!

Sher. To prison, then,
To answer for the lives of these dead men.

Susan. O God! O God!

Sir C. Sweet sister, every strain
Of sorrow from your heart augments my pain;
Your grief abounds,[2835] and hits against my breast.

Sher. Sir, will you go?

Sir C. Even where it likes you best.

[ACT II]

[SCENE I.]

Enter MASTER FRANKFORD in a study.

Frank. How happy am I amongst other men,

That in my mean estate embrace content!
I am a gentleman, and by my birth
Companion with a king; a king's no more.
I am possess'd of many fair revenues,
Sufficient to maintain a gentleman;
Touching my mind, I am studied in all arts;
The riches of my thoughts and of my time
Have been a good proficient;[2836] but, the chief
Of all the sweet felicities on earth,
I have a fair, a chaste, and loving wife, - Perfection all, all truth, all ornament.
If man on earth may truly happy be,
Of these at once possest, sure, I am he.

Enter NICHOLAS.

Nich. Sir, there's a gentleman attends without
To speak with you.

Frank. On horseback?

Nich. Yes, on horseback.

Frank. Entreat him to alight, I will attend him.
Know'st thou him, Nick?

Nich. Know him? Yes; his name 's Wendoll.
It seems, he comes in haste: his horse is booted[2837]
Up to the flank in mire, himself all spotted
And stain'd with plashing. Sure, he rid in fear,
Or for a wager. Horse and man both sweat;
I ne'er saw two in such a smoking heat.

Frank. Entreat him in: about it instantly! [Exit NICHOLAS.]
This Wendoll I have noted, and his carriage
Hath pleas'd me much; by observation
I have noted many good deserts in him.
He's affable, and seen[2838] in many things;
Discourses well; a good companion;
And though of small means, yet a gentleman
Of a good house, though somewhat prest by want.
I have preferr'd him to a second place
In my opinion and my best regard.

Enter WENDOLL, MISTRESS FRANKFORD, and NICHOLAS.

Mrs. F. Oh, Master Frankford! Master Wendoll here
Brings you the strangest news that e'er you heard.

Frank. What news, sweet wife? What news, good Master Wendoll?

Wen. You knew the match made 'twixt Sir Francis Acton
And Sir Charles Mountford?

Frank. True; with their hounds and hawks.

Wen. The matches were both play'd.

Frank. Ha? And which won?

Wen. Sir Francis, your wife's brother, had the worst,
And lost the wager.

Frank. Why, the worse his chance;
Perhaps the fortune of some other day
Will change his luck.

Mrs. F. Oh, but you hear not all.
Sir Francis lost, and yet was loth to yield.
At length the two knights grew to difference,
From words to blows, and so to banding sides;[2839]
Where valorous Sir Charles slew, in his spleen,
Two of your brother's men, - his falconer,
And his good huntsman, whom be lov'd so well.
More men were wounded, no more slain outright.

Frank. Now, trust me, I am sorry for the knight.
But is my brother safe?

Wen. All whole and sound.
His body not being blemish'd with one wound.
But poor Sir Charles is to the prison led,
To answer at th' assize for them that's dead.

Frank. I thank your pains, sir. Had the news been better,
Your will was to have brought it, Master Wendoll.
Sir Charles will find hard friends; his case is heinous
And will be most severely censur'd[2840] on.
I'm sorry for him. Sir, a word with you!
I know you, sir, to be a gentleman
In all things; your possibilities[2841] but mean:
Please you to use my table and my purse;
They're yours.

Wen. O Lord, sir! I shall ne'er deserve it.

Frank. O sir, disparage not your worth too much:

You are full of quality[2842] and fair desert.
Choose of my men which shall attend on you,
And he is yours. I will allow you, sir,
Your man, your gelding, and your table, all
At my own charge; be my companion!

Wen. Master Frankford, I have oft been bound to you
By many favours; this exceeds them all,
That I shall never merit your least favour;
But when your last remembrance I forget,
Heaven at my soul exact that weighty debt!

Frank. There needs no protestation; for I know you
Virtuous, and therefore grateful. - Prithee, Nan,
Use him with all thy loving'st courtesy!

Mrs. F. As far as modesty may well extend,
It is my duty to receive your friend.

Frank. To dinner! Come, sir, from this present day,
Welcome to me for ever! Come, away!
Exeunt [FRANKFORD, MISTRESS FRANKFORD, and WENDOLL].

Nich. I do not like this fellow by no means:
I never see him but my heart still yearns.[2843]
Zounds! I could fight with him, yet know not why;
The devil and he are all one in mine eye.

Enter JENKIN.

Jen. O Nick! What gentleman is that comes to lie at our house? My master allows him one to wait on him, and I believe it will fall to thy lot.

Nich. I love my master; by these hilts, I do; But rather than I'll ever come to serve him, I'll turn away my master.

Enter CICELY.

Cic. Nich'las! where are you, Nich'las? You must come in, Nich'las, and help the young gentleman off with his boots.

Nich. If I pluck off his boots, I'll eat the spurs,
And they shall stick fast in my throat like burrs.

Cic. Then, Jenkin, come you!

Jen. Nay, 'tis no boot[2844] for me to deny it. My master

hath given me a coat here, but he takes pains himself to brush it
once or twice a day with a holly wand.

Cic. Come, come, make haste, that you may wash your hands again,
and help to serve in dinner!

Jen. You may see, my masters, though it be afternoon with you, 'tis
yet but early days with us, for we have not din'd yet. Stay but a
little; I'll but go in and help to bear up the first course,
and come to you again presently. Exeunt.

[SCENE II.][2845]

Enter MALBY and CRANWELL.

Mal. This is the sessions-day; pray can you tell me
How young Sir Charles hath sped? Is he acquit,
Or must he try the laws' strict penalty?

Cran. He's clear'd of all, spite of his enemies,
Whose earnest labour was to take his life.
But in this suit of pardon he hath spent
All the revenues that his father left him;
And he is now turn'd a plain countryman,
Reform'd[2846] in all things. See, sir, here he comes.

Enter SIR CHARLES and his Keeper.

Keep. Discharge your fees, and you are then at freedom.

Sir C. Here, Master Keeper, take the poor remainder
Of all the wealth I have! My heavy foes
Have made my purse light; but, alas! to me
'Tis wealth enough that you have set me free.

Mal. God give you joy of your delivery!
I am glad to see you abroad, Sir Charles.

Sir C. The poorest knight in England, Master Malby.
My life has cost me all my patrimony
My father left his son. Well, God forgive them
That are the authors of my penury!

Enter SHAFTON.

Shaft. Sir Charles! A hand, a hand! At liberty?
Now, by the faith I owe, I am glad to see it.

What want you? Wherein may I pleasure you?

Sir C. Oh me! Oh, most unhappy gentleman!
I am not worthy to have friends stirr'd up,
Whose hands may help me in this plunge of want.
I would I were in Heaven, to inherit there
Th' immortal birthright which my Saviour keeps,
And by no unthrift can be bought and sold;
For here on earth what pleasures should we trust!

Shaft. To rid you from these contemplations,
Three hundred pounds you shall receive of me;
Nay, five for fail.[2847] Come, sir, the sight of gold
Is the most sweet receipt for melancholy,
And will revive your spirits. You shall hold law
With your proud adversaries. Tush! let Frank Acton
Wage, with his knighthood, like expense with me,
And he will sink, he will. - Nay, good Sir Charles,
Applaud your fortune and your fair escape
From all these perils.

Sir C. Oh, sir! they have undone me.
Two thousand and five hundred pound a year
My father at his death possest me of;
All which the envious Acton made me spend;
And, notwithstanding all this large expense,
I had much ado to gain my liberty;
And I have only now a house of pleasure,
With some five hundred pounds reserv'd,
Both to maintain me and my loving sister.

Shaft. [Aside.] That must I have, it lies convenient for me.
If I can fasten but one finger on him,
With my full hand I'll gripe him to the heart.
'Tis not for love I proffer'd him this coin,
But for my gain and pleasure. - Come, Sir Charles,
I know you have need of money; take my offer.

Sir C. Sir, I accept it, and remain indebted
Even to the best of my unable[2848] power.
Come, gentlemen, and see it tend'red down![2849] [Exeunt.]

[SCENE III.][2850]

Enter WENDOLL, melancholy.

Wen. I am a villain, if I apprehend[2851]

But such a thought! Then, to attempt the deed,
Slave, thou art damn'd without redemption. - I'll drive away this passion with a song.
A song! Ha, ha! A song! As if, fond[2852] man,
Thy eyes could swim in laughter, when thy soul
Lies drench'd and drowned in red tears of blood!
I'll pray, and see if God within my heart
Plant better thoughts. Why, prayers are meditations,
And when I meditate (oh, God forgive me!)
It is on her divine perfections.
I will forget her; I will arm myself
Not t' entertain a thought of love to her;
And, when I come by chance into her presence,
I'll hale these balls until my eye-strings crack.
From being pull'd and drawn to look that way.
Enter, over the Stage, FRANKFORD, his Wife, and NICHOLAS and
exit].
O God, O God! With what a violence
I'm hurried to mine own destruction!
There goest thou, the most perfectest man
That ever England bred a gentleman,
And shall I wrong his bed? - Thou God of thunder!
Stay, in Thy thoughts of vengeance and of wrath,
Thy great, almighty, and all-judging hand
From speedy execution on a villain, - A villain and a traitor to his friend.

Enter JENKIN.

Jen. Did your worship call?

Wen. He doth maintain me; he allows me largely
Money to spend.

Jen. By my faith, so do not you me: I cannot get a cross of you.

Wen. My gelding, and my man.

Jen. That's Sorrel and I.

Wen. This kindness grows of no alliance[2853] 'twixt us.

Jen. Nor is my service of any great acquaintance.

Wen. I never bound him to me by desert.
Of a mere stranger, a poor gentleman,
A man by whom in no kind he could gain,
He hath plac'd me in the height of all his thoughts,
Made me companion with the best and chiefest
In Yorkshire. He cannot eat without me,

Nor laugh without me; I am to his body
As necessary as his digestion,
And equally do make him whole or sick.
And shall I wrong this man? Base man! Ingrate!
Hast thou the power, straight with thy gory hands,
To rip thy image from his bleeding heart,
To scratch thy name from out the holy book
Of his remembrance, and to wound his name
That holds thy name so dear? Or rend his heart
To whom thy heart was knit and join'd together? -
And yet I must. Then Wendoll, be content!
Thus villains, when they would, cannot repent.

Jen. What a strange humour is my new master in! Pray God he be not mad; if he should be so, I should never have any mind to serve him in Bedlam. It may be he's mad for missing of me.

Wen. What, Jenkin! Where's your mistress?

Jen. Is your worship married?

Wen. Why dost thou ask?

Jen. Because you are my master; and if I have a mistress, I would be glad, like a good servant, to do my duty to her.

Wen. I mean Mistress Frankford.

Jen. Marry, sir, her husband is riding out of town, and she went very lovingly to bring him on his way to horse. Do you see, sir? Here she comes, and here I go.

Wen. Vanish! [Exit JENKINS.]

Enter MISTRESS FRANKFORD.

Mrs. F. You are well met, sir; now, in troth, my husband
Before he took horse, had a great desire
To speak with you; we sought about the house,
Halloo'd into the fields, sent every way,
But could not meet you. Therefore, he enjoin'd me
To do unto you his most kind commends, - Nay, more: he wills you, as you prize his love,
Or hold in estimation his kind friendship,
To make bold in his absence, and command
Even as himself were present in the house;
For you must keep his table, use his servants,
And be a present Frankford in his absence.

Wen. I thank him for his love. - [Aside.] Give me a name, you, whose infectious tongues
Are tipt with gall and poison: as you would
Think on a man that had your father slain,
Murd'red your children, made your wives base strumpets,
So call me, call me so: print in my face
The most stigmatic[2854] title of a villain,
For hatching treason to so true a friend!

Mrs. F. Sir, you are much beholding to my husband;
You are a man most dear in his regard.

Wen. I am bound unto your husband, and you too.
[Aside.] I will not speak to wrong a gentleman
Of that good estimation, my kind friend.
I will not: zounds! I will not. I may choose,
And I will choose. Shall I be so misled,
Or shall I purchase[2855] to my father's crest
The motto of a villain? If I say
I will not do it, what thing can enforce me?
What can compel me? What sad destiny
Hath such command upon my yielding thoughts?
I will not; - ha! Some fury pricks me on;
The swift fates drag me at their chariot wheel,
And hurry me to mischief. Speak I must:
Injure myself, wrong her, deceive his trust!

Mrs. F. Are you not well, sir, that you seem thus troubled?
There is sedition in your countenance.

Wen. And in my heart, fair angel, chaste and wise.
I love you! Start not, speak not, answer not;
I love you, - nay, let me speak the rest;
Bid me to swear, and I will call to record
The host of Heaven.

Mrs. F. The host of Heaven forbid
Wendoll should hatch such a disloyal thought?

Wen. Such is my fate; to this suit was I born,
To wear rich pleasure's crown, or fortune's scorn.

Mrs. F. My husband loves you.

Wen. I know it.

Mrs. F. He esteems you,
Even as his brain, his eye-ball, or his heart.

Wen. I have tried it.

Mrs. F. His purse is your exchequer, and his table
Doth freely serve you.

Wen. So I have found it.

Mrs. F. Oh! With what face of brass, what brow of steel,
Can you, unblushing, speak this to the face
Of the espous'd wife of so dear a friend?
It is my husband that maintains your state. - Will you dishonour him that in your power
Hath left his whole affairs? I am his wife.
It is to me you speak.

Wen. O speak no more;
For more than this I know, and have recorded
Within the red-leav'd table of my heart.
Fair, and of all belov'd, I was not fearful
Bluntly to give my life into your hand,
And at one hazard all my earthly means.
Go, tell your husband; he will turn me off,
And I am then undone. I care not, I;
'T was for your sake. Perchance, in rage he'll kill me;
I care not, 't was for you. Say I incur
The general name of villain through the world,
Of traitor to my friend; I care not, I.
Beggary, shame, death, scandal, and reproach, -
For you I'll hazard all. Why, what care I?
For you I'll live, and in your love I'll die.

Mrs. F. You move me, sir, to passion and to pity.
The love I bear my husband is as precious
As my soul's health.

Wen. I love your husband too,
And for his love I will engage my life.
Mistake me not; the augmentation
Of my sincere affection borne to you
Doth no whit lessen my regard to him.
I will be secret, lady, close as night;
And not the light of one small glorious star
Shall shine here in my forehead, to bewray
That act of night.

Mrs. F. What shall I say?
My soul is wandering, hath lost her way.
Oh, Master Wendoll! Oh!

Wen. Sigh not, sweet saint;
For every sigh you breathe draws from my heart
A drop of blood.

Mrs. F. I ne'er offended yet:
My fault, I fear, will in my brow be writ.
Women that fall, not quite bereft of grace,
Have their offences noted in their face.
I blush, and am asham'd. Oh, Master Wendoll
Pray God I be not born to curse your tongue,
That hath enchanted me! This maze I am in
I fear will prove the labyrinth of sin.

Enter NICHOLAS [behind].

Wen. The path of pleasure and the gate to bliss,
Which on your lips I knock at with a kiss!

Nich. I'll kill the rogue.

Wen. Your husband is from home, your bed's no blab.
Nay, look not down and blush!
[Exeunt WENDOLL and MISTRESS FRANKFORD.]

Nich. Zounds! I'll stab.
Ay, Nick, was it thy chance to come just in the nick?
I love my master, and I hate that slave;
I love my mistress, but these tricks I like not.
My master shall not pocket up this wrong;
I'll eat my fingers first. What say'st thou, metal?
Does not that rascal Wendoll go on legs
That thou must cut off? Hath he not hamstrings
That thou must hough? Nay, metal, thou shalt stand
To all I say. I'll henceforth turn a spy,
And watch them in their close conveyances.[2856]
I never look'd for better of that rascal,
Since he came miching[2857] first into our house.
It is that Satan hath corrupted her;
For she was fair and chaste. I'll have an eye
In all their gestures. Thus I think of them:
If they proceed as they have done before,
Wendoll's a knave, my mistress is a - - Exit.

[ACT III]

[SCENE I.][2858]

Enter SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD and SUSAN.

Sir C. Sister, you see we are driven to hard shift,
To keep this poor house we have left unsold.
I 'm now enforc'd to follow husbandry,
And you to milk; and do we not live well?
Well, I thank God.

Susan. Oh, brother! here's a change,
Since old Sir Charles died in our father's house.

Sir C. All things on earth thus change, some up, some down;
Content 's a kingdom, and I wear that crown.

Enter SHAFTON, with a Sergeant.

Shaft. Good morrow, morrow, Sir Charles! What! With your sister,
Plying your husbandry? - Sergeant, stand off! - You have a pretty house here, and a garden,
And goodly ground about it. Since it lies
So near a lordship that I lately bought,
I would fain buy it of you. I will give you - - Sir C. Oh, pardon me; this house successively
Hath long'd to me and my progenitors
Three hundred years. My great-great-grandfather,
He in whom first our gentle style began,
Dwelt here, and in this ground increast this mole-hill
Unto that mountain which my father left me.
Where he the first of all our house began,
I now the last will end, and keep this house, - This virgin title, never yet deflower'd
By any unthrift of the Mountfords' line.
In brief, I will not sell it for more gold
Than you could hide or pave the ground withal.

Shaft. Ha, ha! a proud mind and a beggar's purse!
Where 's my three hundred pounds, besides the use?[2859]
I have brought it to an execution
By course of law. What! Is my money ready?

Sir C. An execution, sir, and never tell me
You put my bond in suit? You deal extremely.[2860]

Shaft. Sell me the land, and I 'll acquit you straight.

Sir C. Alas, alas! 'T is all trouble hath left me
To cherish me and my poor sister's life,
If this were sold, our names should then be quite

Raz'd from the bead-roll[2861] of gentility.
You see what hard shift we have made to keep it
Allied still to our name. This palm you see,
Labour hath glow'd within; her silver brow,
That never tasted a rough winter's blast
Without a mask or fan, doth with a grace
Defy cold winter, and his storms outface.

Susan. Sir, we feed sparing, and we labour hard,
We lie uneasy, to reserve to us
And our succession this small spot of ground.

Sir C. I have so bent my thoughts to husbandry,
That I protest I scarcely can remember
What a new fashion is; how silk or satin
Feels in my hand. Why, pride is grown to us
A mere, mere stranger. I have quite forgot
The names of all that ever waited on me.
I cannot name ye any of my hounds,
Once from whose echoing mouths I heard all music
That e'er my heart desir'd. What should I say?
To keep this place, I have chang'd myself away.

Shaft. Arrest him at my suit! - Actions and actions
Shall keep thee in perpetual bondage fast;
Nay, more. I 'll sue thee by a late appeal,
And call thy former life in question.
The keeper is my friend; thou shalt have irons,
And usage such as I 'll deny to dogs. - Away with him!

Sir C. You are too timorous.[2862]
But trouble is my master,
And I will serve him truly. - My kind sister,
Thy tears are of no use to mollify
The flinty man. Go to my father's brother,
My kinsmen, and allies; entreat them for me,
To ransom me from this injurious man
That seeks my ruin.

Shaft. Come, irons! Come away;
I 'll see thee lodg'd far from the sight of day.
Exeunt [except SUSAN].

Susan. My heart's so hard'ned with the frost of grief,
Death cannot pierce it through. - Tyrant too fell!
So lead the fiends condemned souls to hell.

Enter SIR FRANCIS ACTON and MALBY.

Sir F. Again to prison! Malby, hast thou seen
A poor slave better tortur'd? Shall we hear
The music of his voice cry from the grate,[2863]
Meat, for the Lord's sake? No, no; yet I am not
Throughly reveng'd. They say, he hath a pretty wench
Unto his sister; shall I, in mercy-sake
To him and to his kindred, bribe the fool
To shame herself by lewd, dishonest lust?
I 'll proffer largely; but, the deed being done,
I 'll smile to see her base confusion.

Mal. Methinks, Sir Francis, you are full reveng'd
For greater wrongs than he can proffer you.
See where the poor sad gentlewoman stands!

Sir F. Ha, ha! Now will I flout her poverty,
Deride her fortunes, scoff her base estate;
My very soul the name of Mountford hates.
But stay, my heart! Oh, what a look did fly
To strike my soul through with thy piercing eye!
I am enchanted; all my spirits are fled.
And with one glance my envious spleen struck dead.

Susan. Acton! That seeks our blood! Runs away.

Sir F. O chaste and fair!

Mal. Sir Francis! Why, Sir Francis! Zounds, in a trance?
Sir Francis! What cheer, man? Come, come, how is 't?

Sir F. Was she not fair? Or else this judging eye
Cannot distinguish beauty.

Mal. She was fair.

Sir F. She was an angel in a mortal's shape,
And ne'er descended from old Mountford's line.
But soft, soft, let me call my wits together!
A poor, poor wench, to my great adversary
Sister, whose very souls denounce stern war
One against other! How now, Frank, turn'd fool
Or madman, whether? But no! Master of
My perfect senses and directest wits.
Then why should I be in this violent humour
Of passion and of love? And with a person
So different every way, and so oppos'd
In all contractions[2864] and still-warring actions?

Fie, fie! How I dispute against my soul!
Come, come; I'll gain her, or in her fair quest
Purchase my soul free and immortal rest. [Exeunt.]

[SCENE II.][2865]

Enter three or four Serving-men, one with a voider[2866] and a wooden knife, to take away all; another the salt and bread; another with the table-cloth and napkins; another the carpet;[2867] JENKIN with two lights after them.

Jen. So; march in order, and retire in battle array! My master and the guests have supp'd already; all 's taken away. Here, now spread for the serving-men in the hall! - Butler, it belongs to your office.

But. I know it, Jenkin. What d' ye call the gentleman that supp'd there to-night?

Jen. Who? My master?

But. No, no; Master Wendoll, he's a daily guest. I mean the gentleman that came but this afternoon.

Jen. His name's Master Cranwell. God's light! Hark, within there; my master calls to lay more billets[2868] upon the fire. Come, come! Lord, how we that are in office here in the house are troubled! One spread the carpet in the parlour, and stand ready to snuff the lights; the rest be ready to prepare their stomachs! More lights in the hall, there! Come, Nicholas.
Exeunt [all but NICHOLAS].

Nich. I cannot eat; but had I Wendoll's heart,
I would eat that. The rogue grows impudent,
Oh! I have seen such vile, notorious tricks,
Ready to make my eyes dart from my head.
I'll tell my master: by this air, I will;
Fall what may fall, I'll tell him. Here he comes.

Enter MASTER FRANKFORD, as it were brushing the crumbs from his clothes with a napkin, as newly risen from supper.

Frank. Nicholas, what make you here? Why are not you
At supper in the hall, among your fellows?

Nich. Master, I stay'd your rising from the board,
To speak with you.

Frank. Be brief then, gentle Nicholas;
My wife and guests attend[2869] me in the parlour.
Why dost thou pause? Now, Nicholas, you want money,
And, unthrift-like, would eat into your wages
Ere you had earn'd it. Here, sir, 's half-a-crown;
Play the good husband,[2870] - and away to supper!

Nich. By this hand, an honourable gentleman!
I will not see him wrong'd.
Sir, I have serv'd you long; you entertain'd me
Seven years before your beard; you knew me, sir,
Before you knew my mistress.

Frank. What of this, good Nicholas?

Nich. I never was a make-bate[2871] or a knave;
I have no fault but one - I'm given to quarrel,
But not with women. I will tell you, master,
That which will make your heart leap from your breast,
Your hair to startle from your head, your ears to tingle.

Frank. What preparation's this to dismal news?

Nich. 'Sblood! sir, I love you better than your wife.
I'll make it good.

Frank. You are a knave, and I have much ado
With wonted patience to contain my rage,
And not to break thy pate. Thou art a knave.
I'll turn you, with your base comparisons,
Out of my doors.

Nich. Do, do.
There is not room for Wendoll and me too,
Both in one house. O master, master,
That Wendoll is a villain!

Frank. Ay, saucy?

Nich. Strike, strike, do strike; yet hear me! I am no fool;
I know a villain, when I see him act
Deeds of a villain. Master, master, the base slave
Enjoys my mistress, and dishonours you.

Frank. Thou hast kill'd me with a weapon, whose sharp point
Hath prick'd quite through and through my shiv'ring heart.
Drops of cold sweat sit dangling on my hairs,
Like morning's dew upon the golden flowers,

And I am plung'd into strange agonies.
What did'st thou say? If any word that toucht
His credit, or her reputation,
It is as hard to enter my belief,
As Dives into heaven.

Nich. I can gain nothing:
They are two that never wrong'd me. I knew before
'T was but a thankless office, and perhaps
As much as is my service, or my life
Is worth. All this I know; but this, and more,
More by a thousand dangers, could not hire me
To smother such a heinous wrong from you.
I saw, and I have said.

Frank. 'T is probable. Though blunt, yet he is honest.
Though I durst pawn my life, and on their faith
Hazard the dear salvation of my soul,
Yet in my trust I may be too secure.
May this be true? Oh, may it? Can it be?
Is it by any wonder possible?
Man, woman, what thing mortal can we trust,
When friends and bosom wives prove so unjust? - What instance[2872] hast thou of this strange report?

Nich. Eyes, [master,] eyes.

Frank. Thy eyes may be deceiv'd, I tell thee;
For should an angel from the heavens drop down,
And preach this to me that thyself hast told,
He should have much ado to win belief;
In both their loves I am so confident.

Nich. Shall I discourse the same by circumstance?

Frank. No more! To supper, and command your fellows
To attend us and the strangers! Not a word,
I charge thee, on thy life! Be secret then;
For I know nothing.

Nich. I am dumb; and, now that I have eas'd my stomach,[2873]
I will go fill my stomach. [Exit.]

Frank. Away! Begone! - She is well born, descended nobly;
Virtuous her education; her repute
Is in the general voice of all the country
Honest and fair; her carriage, her demeanour,
In all her actions that concern the love
To me her husband, modest, chaste, and godly.

Is all this seeming gold plain copper?
But he, that Judas that hath borne my purse,
Hath sold me for a sin. O God! O God!
Shall I put up these wrongs? No! Shall I trust
The bare report of this suspicious groom,
Before the double-gilt, the well-hatch'd[2874] ore
Of their two hearts? No, I will lose these thoughts;
Distraction I will banish from my brow,
And from my looks exile sad discontent.
Their wonted favours in my tongue shall flow;
Till I know all, I 'll nothing seem to know. - Lights and a table there! Wife, Master Wendoll,
And gentle Master Cranwell!

Enter MISTRESS FRANKFORD, MASTER WENDOLL, MASTER CRANWELL, NICHOLAS, and JENKIN with cards, carpets, stools, and other necessaries.

Frank. O! Master Cranwell, you are a stranger here,
And often balk[2875] my house; faith, y' are a churl! - Now we have supp'd, a table, and to cards!

Jen. A pair[2876] of cards, Nicholas, and a carpet to cover the table! Where 's Cicely, with her counters and her box? Candles and candlesticks, there! Fie! We have such a household of serving-creatures! Unless it be Nick and I, there's not one amongst them all that can say bo to a goose. - Well said,[2877] Nick!
They spread a carpet: set down lights and cards.

Mrs. F. Come, Mr. Frankford, who shall take my part?[2878]

Frank. Marry, that will I, sweet wife.

Wen. No, by my faith, when you are together, I sit out. It must be Mistress Frankford and I, or else it is no match.

Frank. I do not like that match.

Nich. [Aside.] You have no reason, marry, knowing all.

Frank. 'T is no great matter, neither. - Come, Master Cranwell, shall you and I take them up?[2879]

Cran. At your pleasure, sir.

Frank. I must look to you, Master Wendoll, for you 'll be playing false. Nay, so will my wife, too.

Nich. [Aside.] Ay, I will be sworn she will.

Mrs. F. Let them that are taken playing false, forfeit the set!

Frank. Content; it shall go hard but I 'll take you.

Cran. Gentlemen, what shall our game be?

Wen. Master Frankford, you play best at noddy.[2880]

Frank. You shall not find it so; indeed, you shall not.

Mrs. F. I can play at nothing so well as double-ruff.[2881]

Frank. If Master Wendoll and my wife be together, there 's no playing against them at double-hand.

Nich. I can tell you, sir, the game that Master Wendoll is best at.

Wen. What game is that, Nick?

Nich. Marry, sir, knave out of doors.

Wen. She and I will take you at lodam.

Mrs. F. Husband, shall we play at saint?

Frank. [Aside.] My saint 's turn'd devil. - No, we 'll none of saint:
You are best at new-cut, wife, you 'll play at that.

Wen. If you play at new-cut, I 'm soonest hitter of any here, for a wager.

Frank. [Aside.] 'T is me they play on. - Well, you may draw out;
For all your cunning, 't will be to your shame;
I'll teach you, at your new-cut, a new game.
Come, come!

Cran. If you cannot agree upon the game,
To post and pair!

Wen. We shall be soonest pairs; and my good host,
When he comes late home, he must kiss the post.[2882]

Frank. Whoever wins, it shall be to thy cost.

Cran. Faith, let it be vide-ruff, and let's make honours!

Frank. If you make honours, one thing let me crave:

Honour the king and queen, except the knave.

Wen. Well, as you please for that. - Lift,[2883] who shall deal?

Mrs. F. The least in sight. What are you, Master Wendoll?

Wen. I am a knave.

Nich. [Aside.] I'll swear it.

Mrs. F. I a queen.

Frank. [Aside.] A quean, thou should'st say. - Well, the cards
are mine:
They are the grossest pair[2884] that e'er I felt.

Mrs. F. Shuffle, I'll cut: would I had never dealt!

Frank. I have lost my dealing.

Wen. Sir, the fault's in me;
This queen I have more than mine own, you see.
Give me the stock![2884]

Frank. My mind 's not on my game.
Many a deal I've lost; the more 's your shame.
You have serv'd me a bad trick, Master Wendoll.

Wen. Sir, you must take your lot. To end this strife,
I know I have dealt better with your wife.

Frank. Thou hast dealt falsely, then.

Mrs. F. What 's trumps?

Wen. Hearts. Partner, I rub.

Frank. [Aside.] Thou robb'st me of my soul, of her chaste love;
In thy false dealing thou hast robb'd my heart. - Booty you play; I like a loser stand,
Having no heart, or here or in my hand.
I will give o'er the set, I am not well.
Come, who will hold my cards?

Mrs. F. Not well, sweet Master Frankford?
Alas what ails you? 'T is some sudden qualm.

Wen. How long have you been so, Master Frankford?

Frank. Sir, I was lusty, and I had my health,
But I grew ill when you began to deal. - Take hence this table! - Gentle Master Cranwell,
Y' are welcome; see your chamber at your pleasure!
I am sorry that this megrim takes me so,
I cannot sit and bear you company. - Jenkin, some lights, and show him to his chamber![2885]

Mrs. F. A nightgown for my husband; quickly, there!
It is some rheum or cold.

Wen. Now, in good faith,
This illness you have got by sitting late
Without your gown.

Frank. I know it, Master Wendoll.
Go, go to bed, lest you complain like me! - Wife, prithee, wife, into my bed-chamber!
The night is raw and cold, and rheumatic.
Leave me my gown and light; I 'll walk away my fit.

Wen. Sweet sir, good night!

Frank. Myself, good night! [Exit Wendoll.]

Mrs. F. Shall I attend you, husband?

Frank. No, gentle wife, thou 'lt catch cold in thy head.
Prithee, begone, sweet; I'll make haste to bed.

Mrs. F. No sleep will fasten on mine eyes, you know,
Until you come. [Exit.]

Frank. Sweet Nan, I prithee, go! - I have bethought me; get me by degrees
The keys of all my doors, which I will mould
In wax, and take their fair impression,
To have by them new keys. This being compast,
At a set hour a letter shall be brought me,
And when they think they may securely play,
They nearest are to danger. - Nick, I must rely
Upon thy trust and faithful secrecy.

Nich. Build on my faith!

Frank. To bed, then, not to rest!
Care lodges in my brain, grief in my breast. [Exeunt.]

[SCENE III.][2886]

Enter SIR CHARLES'S Sister, OLD MOUNTFORD, SANDY, RODER, and TIDY.

Old Mount. You say my nephew is in great distress;
Who brought it to him but his own lewd life?
I cannot spare a cross. I must confess,
He was my brother's son; why, niece, what then?
This is no world in which to pity men.

Susan. I was not born a beggar, though his extremes
Enforce this language from me. I protest
No fortune of mine own could lead my tongue
To this base key. I do beseech you, uncle,
For the name's sake, for Christianity, -
Nay, for God's sake, to pity his distress.
He is deni'd the freedom of the prison,
And in the hole is laid with men condemn'd;
Plenty he hath of nothing but of irons,
And it remains in you to free him thence.

Old Mount. Money I cannot spare; men should take heed.
He lost my kindred when he fell to need. Exit.

Susan. Gold is but earth; thou earth enough shalt have,
When thou hast once took measure of thy grave.
You know me, Master Sandy, and my suit.

Sandy. I knew you, lady, when the old man liv'd;
I knew you ere your brother sold his land.
Then you were Mistress Sue, trick'd up in jewels;
Then you sung well, play'd sweetly on the lute;
But now I neither know you nor your suit.
[Exit.]

Susan. You, Master Roder, was my brother's tenant;
Rent-free he plac'd you in that wealthy farm,
Of which you are possest.

Roder. True, he did;
And have I not there dwelt still for his sake?
I have some business now; but, without doubt,
They that have hurl'd him in, will help him out. Exit.

Susan. Cold comfort still. What say you, cousin Tidy?

Tidy. I say this comes of roysting,[2887] swagg'ring.
Call me not cousin; each man for himself!
Some men are born to mirth, and some to sorrow:
I am no cousin unto them that borrow. Exit.

Susan. O Charity, why art thou fled to heaven,
And left all things [up]on this earth uneven?
Their scoffing answers I will ne'er return,
But to myself his grief in silence mourn.

Enter SIR FRANCIS and MALBY.

Sir F. She is poor, I'll therefore tempt her with this gold.
Go, Malby, in my name deliver it,
And I will stay thy answer.

Mal. Fair mistress, as I understand your grief
Doth grow from want, so I have here in store
A means to furnish you, a bag of gold,
Which to your hands I freely tender you.

Susan. I thank you, Heavens! I thank you, gentle sir:
God make me able to requite this favour!

Mal. This gold Sir Francis Acton sends by me,
And prays you - - Susan. Acton? O God! That name I'm born to curse.
Hence, bawd; hence, broker! See, I spurn his gold.
My honour never shall for gain be sold.

Sir F. Stay, lady, stay!

Susan. From you I'll posting hie,
Even as the doves from feather'd eagles fly. Exit.

Sir F. She hates my name, my face; how should I woo?
I am disgrac'd in every thing I do.
The more she hates me, and disdains my love,
The more I am rapt in admiration
Of her divine and chaste perfections.
Woo her with gifts I cannot, for all gifts
Sent in my name she spurns; with looks I cannot,
For she abhors my sight; nor yet with letters,
For none she will receive. How then? how then?
Well, I will fasten such a kindness on her,
As shall o'ercome her hate and conquer it.
Sir Charles, her brother, lies in execution
For a great sum of money; and, besides,
The appeal is sued still for my huntsmen's death,
Which only I have power to reverse.
In her I'll bury all my hate of him. - Go seek the Keeper, Malby, bring him to me!
To save his body, I his debts will pay;
To save his life, I his appeal will stay. [Exeunt.]

[ACT IV]

[SCENE I.][2888]

Enter SIR CHARLES [MOUNTFORD], in prison, with irons, his feel bare,
his garments all ragged and torn.

Sir C. Of all on the earth's face most miserable,
Breathe in this hellish dungeon thy laments!
Thus like a slave ragg'd, like a felon gyv'd, - That hurls thee headlong to this base estate.
Oh, unkind uncle! Oh, my friends ingrate!
Unthankful kinsmen! Mountford's all too base,
To let thy name be fetter'd in disgrace,
A thousand deaths here in this grave I die;
Fear, hunger, sorrow, cold, all threat my death,
And join together to deprive my breath.
But that which most torments me, my dear sister
Hath left[2889] to visit me, and from my friends
Hath brought no hopeful answer; therefore, I
Divine they will not help my misery.
If it be so, shame, scandal, and contempt
Attend their covetous thoughts; need make their graves!
Usurers they live, and may they die like slaves!

Enter Keeper.

Keep. Knight, be of comfort, for I bring thee freedom
From all thy troubles.

Sir C. Then, I am doom'd to die:
Death is the end of all calamity.

Keep. Live! Your appeal is stay'd; the execution
Of all your debts discharg'd; your creditors
Even to the utmost penny satisfied.
In sign whereof your shackles I knock off.
You are not left so much indebted to us
As for your fees; all is discharg'd; all paid.
Go freely to your house, or where you please;
After long miseries, embrace your ease.

Sir C. Thou grumblest out the sweetest music to me
That ever organ play'd. - Is this a dream?
Or do my waking senses, apprehend

The pleasing taste of these applausive[2890] news?
Slave that I was, to wrong such honest friends,
My loving kinsman, and my near allies!
Tongue, I will bite thee for the scandal breath'd
Against such faithful kinsmen; they are all
Compos'd of pity and compassion,
Of melting charity and of moving ruth.
That which I spoke before was in my rage;
They are my friends, the mirrors of this age;
Bounteous and free. The noble Mountford's race
Ne'er bred a covetous thought, or humour base.

Enter SUSAN.

Susan. I cannot longer stay from visiting
My woful brother. While I could, I kept
My hapless tidings, from his hopeful ear.

Sir C. Sister, how much am I indebted to thee
And to thy travail!

Susan. What, at liberty?

Sir C. Thou seest I am, thanks to thy industry.
Oh! Unto which of all my courteous friends
Am I thus bound? My uncle Mountford, he
Even of an infant lov'd me; was it he?
So did my cousin Tidy; was it he?
So Master Roder, Master Sandy, too.
Which of all these did this high kindness do?

Susan. Charles, can you mock me in your poverty,
Knowing your friends deride your misery?
Now, I protest I stand so much amaz'd,
To see your bonds free, and your irons knock'd off,
That I am rapt into a maze of wonder;
The rather for I know not by what means
This happiness hath chanc'd.

Sir C. Why, by my uncle,
My cousins, and my friends; who else, I pray,
Would take upon them all my debts to pay?

Susan. Oh, brother! they are men [made] all of flint,
Pictures of marble, and as void of pity
As chased bears. I begg'd, I sued, I kneel'd,
Laid open all your griefs and miseries,
Which they derided; more than that, deni'd us

A part in their alliance; but, in pride,
Said that our kindred with our plenty died.

Sir C. Drudges too much,[2891] - what did they? Oh, known evil!
Rich fly the poor, as good men shun the devil.
Whence should my freedom come? Of whom alive,
Saving of those, have I deserv'd go well?
Guess, sister, call to mind, remember me!
These have I rais'd, they follow the world's guise,
Whom rich [they][2892] honour, they in woe despise.

Susan. My wits have lost themselves; let's ask the keeper!

Sir C. Gaoler!

Keep. At hand, sir.

Sir C. Of courtesy resolve me one demand!
What was he took the burden of my debts
From off my back, staid my appeal to death,
Discharg'd my fees, and brought me liberty?

Keep. A courteous knight, one call'd Sir Francis Acton.

Sir C. Ha! Acton! Oh me! More distress'd in this
Than all my troubles! Hale me back,
Double my irons, and my sparing meals
Put into halves, and lodge me in a dungeon
More deep, more dark, more cold, more comfortless!
By Acton freed! Not all thy manacles
Could fetter so my heels, as this one word
Hath thrall'd my heart; and it must now lie bound
In more strict prison than thy stony gaol.
I am not free, I go but under bail.

Keep. My charge is done, sir, now I have my fees.
As we get little, we will nothing leese.[2893]

Sir C. By Acton freed, my dangerous opposite!
Why, to what end? On what occasion? Ha!
Let me forget the name of enemy,
And with indifference balance[2894] this high favour!
Ha!

Susan. [Aside.] His love to me, upon my soul, 't is so!
That is the root from whence these strange things grow.

Sir C. Had this proceeded from my father, he

That by the law of Nature is most bound
In offices of love, it had deserv'd
My best employment to requite that grace.
Had it proceeded from my friends, or him,
From them this action had deserv'd my life, - And from a stranger more, because from such
There is less execution[2895] of good deeds.
But he, nor father, nor ally, nor friend,
More than a stranger, both remote in blood,
And in his heart oppos'd my enemy,
That this high bounty should proceed from him, - Oh! there I lose myself. What should I say,
What think, what do, his bounty to repay?

Susan. You wonder, I am sure, whence this strange kindness
Proceeds in Acton; I will tell you, brother.
He dotes on me, and oft hath sent me gifts,
Letters, and tokens; I refus'd them all.

Sir C. I have enough, though poor: my heart is set,
In one rich gift to pay back all my debt. Exeunt.

[SCENE II.[2896]]

Enter FRANKFORD and NICHOLAS, with keys and a letter in his hand.

Frank. This is the night that I must play my part,
To try two seeming angels. - Where's my keys?

Nich. They are made according to your mould in wax.
I bade the smith be secret, gave him money,
And here they are. The letter, sir!

Frank. True, take it, there it is;
And when thou seest me in my pleasant'st vein,
Ready to sit to supper, bring it me!

Nich. I'll do't; make no more question, but I'll do it. Exit.

Enter MISTRESS FRANKFORD, CRANWELL, WENDOLL, and JENKIN.

Mrs. F. Sirrah, 't is six o'clock already struck;
Go bid them spread the cloth, and serve in supper!

Jen. It shall be done, forsooth, mistress.
Where's Spigot, the butler, to give us out salt
and trenchers?

Wen. We that have been a hunting all the day,

Come with prepared stomachs. - Master Frankford,
We wish'd you at our sport.

Frank. My heart was with you, and my mind was on you. - Fie, Master Cranwell! You are still thus sad. - A stool, a stool! Where's Jenkin, and where's Nick?
'T is supper time at least an hour ago.
What's the best news abroad?

Wen. I know none good.

Frank. [Aside.] But I know too much bad.

Enter Butler and JENKIN, with a table-cloth, bread,
trenchers, and salt; [then exeunt.]

Cran. Methinks, sir, you might have that interest[2897]
In your wife's brother, to be more remiss[2898]
In his hard dealing against poor Sir Charles,
Who, as I hear, lies in York Castle, needy
And in great want.

Frank. Did not more weighty business of mine own
Hold me away, I would have labour'd peace
Betwixt them with all care; indeed I would, sir.

Mrs. F. I'll write unto my brother earnestly
In that behalf.

Wen. A charitable deed,
And will beget the good opinion
Of all your friends that love you, Mistress Frankford.

Frank. That's you, for one; I know you love Sir Charles,
[Aside.] And my wife too, well.

Wen. He deserves the love
Of all true gentlemen; be yourselves judge!

Frank. But supper, ho! - Now, as thou lov'st me, Wendoll,
Which I am sure thou dost, be merry, pleasant,
And frolic it to-night! - Sweet Mr. Cranwell,
Do you the like! - Wife, I protest, my heart
Was ne'er more bent on sweet alacrity.
Where be those lazy knaves to serve in supper?

Enter NICHOLAS.

Nich. Here's a letter, sir.

Frank. Whence comes it, and who brought it?

Nich. A stripling that below attends your answer,
And, as he tells me, it is sent from York.

Frank. Have him into the cellar, let him taste
A cup of our March beer; go, make him drink!

Nich. I'll make him drunk, if he be a Trojan.[2899]

Frank. [after reading the letter.] My boots
and spurs! Where's Jenkin? God forgive me,
How I neglect my business! - Wife, look here!
I have a matter to be tri'd to-morrow
By eight o'clock; and my attorney writes me,
I must be there betimes with evidence,
Or it will go against me. Where's my boots?

Enter JENKIN, with boots and spurs.

Mrs. F. I hope your business craves no such despatch,
That you must ride to-night?

Wen. [Aside.] I hope it doth.

Frank. God's me! No such despatch?
Jenkin, my boots! Where's Nick? Saddle my roan,
And the grey dapple for himself! - Content ye,
It much concerns me. - Gentle Master Cranwell,
And Master Wendoll, in my absence use
The very ripest pleasure of my house!

Wen. Lord! Master Frankford, will you ride to-night?
The ways are dangerous.

Frank. Therefore will I ride
Appointed[2900] well; and so shall Nick, my man.

Mrs. F. I 'll call you up by five o'clock to-morrow.

Frank. No, by my faith, wife, I'll not trust to that:
'T is not such easy rising in a morning
From one I love so dearly. No, by my faith,
I shall not leave so sweet a bedfellow,
But with much pain. You have made me a sluggard
Since I first knew you.

Mrs. F. Then, if you needs will go
This dangerous evening. Master Wendoll,
Let me entreat you bear him company.

Wen. With all my heart, sweet mistress. - My boots, there!

Frank. Fie, fie, that for my private business
I should disease[2901] a friend, and be a trouble
To the whole house! - Nick!

Nich. Anon, sir!

Frank. Bring forth my gelding! - As you love me, sir,
Use no more words: a hand, good Master Cranwell!

Cran. Sir, God be your good speed!

Frank. Good night, sweet Nan; nay, nay, a kiss, and part!
[Aside.] Dissembling lips, you suit not with my heart.
Exeunt [FRANKFORD and NICHOLAS].

Wen. [Aside.] How business, time, and hours, all gracious prove,
And are the furtherers to my new-born love!
I am husband now in Master Frankford's place,
And must command the house. - My pleasure is
We will not sup abroad so publicly,
But in your private chamber, Mistress Frankford.

Mrs. F. Oh, sir! you are too public in your love,
And Master Frankford's wife - - Cran. Might I crave favour,
I would entreat you I might see my chamber.
I am on the sudden grown exceeding ill,
And would be spar'd from supper.

Wen. Light there, ho! - See you want nothing, sir, for if you do,
You injure that good man, and wrong me too.

Cran. I will make bold; good night! [Exit.]

Wen. How all conspire
To make our bosom[2902] sweet, and full entire!
Come, Nan, I pr'ythee, let us sup within!

Mrs. F. Oh! what a clog unto the soul is sin!
We pale offenders are still full of fear;
Every suspicious eye brings danger near;
When they, whose clear hearts from offence are free,
Despise report, base scandals do outface,

And stand at mere defiance with disgrace.

Wen. Fie, fie! You talk too like a puritan.

Mrs. F. You have tempted me to mischief, Master Wendoll:
I have done I know not what. Well, you plead custom;
That which for want of wit I granted erst,
I now must yield through fear. Come, come, let's in;
Once over shoes, we are straight o'er head in sin.

Wen. My jocund soul is joyful beyond measure;
I'll be profuse in Frankford's richest treasure. Exeunt.

[SCENE III.][2903]

Enter CICELY, JENKIN, Butler, and other Serving-men.

Jen. My mistress and Master Wendoll, my master, sup in her chamber to-night. Cicely, you are preferr'd, from being the cook, to be chambermaid. Of all the loves betwixt thee and me, tell me what thou think'st of this?

Cic. Mum; there's an old proverb, - when the cat's away, the mouse may play.

Jen. Now you talk of a cat, Cicely, I smell a rat.

Cic. Good words, Jenkin, lest you be call'd to answer them!

Jen. Why, God make my mistress an honest woman! Are not these good words? Pray God my new master play not the knave with my old master! Is there any hurt in this? God send no villainy intended; and if they do sup together, pray God they do not lie together! God make my mistress chaste, and make us all His servants! What harm is there in all this? Nay, more; here in my hand, thou shalt never have my heart, unless thou say. Amen.

Cic. Amen; I pray God, I say.

Enter Serving-man.

Serving-man. My mistress sends that you should make less noise. So, lock up the doors, and see the household all got to bed! You, Jenkin, for this night are made the porter, to see the gates shut in.

Jen. Thus by little and little I creep into office. Come, to kennel, my masters, to kennel; 't is eleven o'clock already.

Serving-man. When you have lock'd the gates in, you must send up
the keys to my mistress.

Cic. Quickly, for God's sake, Jenkin; for I must carry them. I am
neither pillow nor bolster, but I know more than both.

Jen. To bed, good Spigot; to bed, good honest serving-creatures;
and let us sleep as snug as pigs in pease-straw! Exeunt.

[SCENE IV.][2904]

Enter FRANKFORD and NICHOLAS.

Frank. Soft, soft! We 've tied our geldings to a tree,
Two flight-shot[2905] off, lest by their thundering hoofs
They blab our coming back. Hear'st thou no noise?

Nich. Hear? I hear nothing but the owl and you.

Frank. So; now my watch's hand points upon twelve,
And it is dead midnight. Where are my keys?

Nich. Here, sir.

Frank. This is the key that opes my outward gate;
This, the hall-door; this, the withdrawing-chamber;
But this, that door that's bawd unto my shame,
Fountain and spring of all my bleeding thoughts,
Where the most hallowed order and true knot
Of nuptial sanctity hath been profan'd.
It leads to my polluted bed-chamber,
Once my terrestrial heaven, now my earth's hell,
The place where sins in all their ripeness dwell. - But I forget myself; now to my gate!

Nich. It must ope with far less noise than
Cripplegate, or your plot's dash'd.

Frank. So; reach me my dark lantern to the rest!
Tread softly, softly!

Nich. I will walk on eggs this pace.

Frank. A general silence hath surpris'd the house.
And this is the last door. Astonishment,
Fear, and amazement, beat upon my heart,
Even as a madman beats upon a drum.

Oh, keep my eyes, you Heavens, before I enter,
From any sight that may transfix my soul;
Or, if there be so black a spectacle,
Oh, strike mine eyes stark blind; or if not so,
Lend me such patience to digest my grief,
That I may keep this white and virgin hand
From any violent outrage, or red murder! - And with that prayer I enter. [Exeunt into the house.]

[SCENE V.][2906]

[Enter NICHOLAS.]

Nich. Here's a circumstance![2907]
A man may be made cuckold in the time
That he 's about it. An the case were mine.
As 't is my master's, 'sblood! (that he makes me swear!),
I would have plac'd his action,[2908] enter'd there;
I would, I would!

[Enter FRANKFORD.]

Frank. Oh! oh!

Nich. Master! 'Sblood! Master, master!

Frank. Oh me unhappy! I have found them lying
Close in each other's arms, and fast asleep.
But that I would not damn two precious souls,
Bought with my Saviour's blood, and send them, laden
With all their scarlet sins upon their backs,
Unto a fearful judgment, their two lives
Had met upon my rapier.

Nich. Master, what, have you left them sleeping still?
Let me go wake 'em!

Frank. Stay, let me pause awhile! - Oh, God! Oh, God! That it were possible
To undo things done; to call back yesterday;
That Time could turn up his swift sandy glass,
To untell[2909] the days, and to redeem these hours!
Or that the sun
Could, rising from the west, draw his coach backward;
Take from th' account of time so many minutes,
Till he had all these seasons call'd again,
Those minutes, and those actions done in them,
Even from her first offence; that I might take her
As spotless as an angel in my arms!

But, oh! I talk of things impossible,
And cast beyond the moon. God give me patience;
For I will in, and wake them. Exit.

Nich. Here's patience perforce!
He needs must trot afoot that tires his horse. [Exit.]

Enter WENDOLL, running over the stage in a night-gown,[2910]
FRANKFORD after him with his sword drawn; a maid in her smock stays
his hand, and clasps hold on him. He pauses for a while.

Frank. I thank thee, maid; thou, like the angel's hand,
Hast stay'd me from a bloody sacrifice. - Go, villain; and my wrongs sit on thy soul
As heavy as this grief doth upon mine!
When thou record'st my many courtesies,
And shalt compare them with thy treacherous heart,
Lay them together, weigh them equally, - 'T will be revenge enough. Go, to thy friend
A Judas; pray, pray, lest I live to see
Thee, Judas-like, hang'd on an elder-tree!

Enter MISTRESS FRANKFORD in her smock, night-gown, and night-attire.

Mrs. F. Oh, by what word, what title, or what name,
Shall I entreat your pardon? Pardon! Oh!
I am as far from hoping such sweet grace,
As Lucifer from Heaven. To call you husband, -
(Oh me, most wretched!) I have lost that name;
I am no more your wife.

Nich. 'Sblood, sir, she swoons.

Frank. Spare thou thy tears, for I will weep for thee;
And keep thy count'nance, for I 'll blush for thee.
Now, I protest, I think 't is I am tainted,
For I am most asham'd; and 't is more hard
For me to look upon thy guilty face
Than on the sun's clear brow. What! Would'st thou speak?

Mrs. F. I would I had no tongue, no ears, no eyes,
No apprehension, no capacity.
When do you spurn me like a dog? When tread me
Under feet? When drag me by the hair?
Though I deserve a thousand, thousand fold,
More than you can inflict - yet, once my husband,
For womanhood, to which I am a shame,
Though once an ornament - even for His sake,
That hath redeem'd our souls, mark not my face,
Nor hack me with your sword; but let me go

Perfect and undeformed to my tomb!
I am not worthy that I should prevail
In the least suit; no, not to speak to you,
Nor look on you, nor to be in your presence;
Yet, as an abject,[2911] this one suit I crave; - This granted, I am ready for my grave.

Frank. My God, with patience arm me! - Rise, nay, rise,
And I 'll debate with thee. Was it for want
Thou play'dst the strumpet? Wast thou not suppli'd
With every pleasure, fashion, and new toy, - Nay, even beyond my calling?[2912]

Mrs. F. I was.

Frank. Was it, then, disability in me;
Or in thine eye seem'd he a properer man?

Mrs. F. Oh, no!

Frank. Did I not lodge thee in my bosom?
Wear thee here in my heart?

Mrs. F. You did.

Frank. I did, indeed; witness my tears, I did - Go, bring my infants hither! - [Two Children are brought in.]
Oh, Nan! Oh, Nan!
If neither fear of shame, regard of honour,
The blemish of my house, nor my dear love,
Could have withheld thee from so lewd a fact;
Yet for these infants, these young, harmless souls,
On whose white brows thy shame is character'd,
And grows in greatness as they wax in years, - Look but on them, and melt away in tears! - Away with them; lest, as her spotted body
Hath stain'd their names with stripe of bastardy,
So her adulterous breath may blast their spirits
With her infectious thoughts! Away with them! [Exeunt Children.]

Mrs. F. In this one life, I die ten thousand deaths.

Frank. Stand up, stand up! I will do nothing rashly.
I will retire awhile into my study,
And thou shalt hear thy sentence presently. Exit.

Mrs. F. 'T is welcome, be it death. Oh me, base strumpet,
That, having such a husband, such sweet children,
Must enjoy neither! Oh, to redeem mine honour,
I 'd have this hand cut off, these my breasts sear'd;
Be rack'd, strappado'd, put to any torment:
Nay, to whip but this scandal out, I'd hazard

The rich and dear redemption of my soul!
He cannot be so base as to forgive me,
Nor I so shameless to accept his pardon.
Oh, women, women, you that yet have kept
Your holy matrimonial vow unstain'd,
Make me your instance; when you tread awry,
Your sins, like mine, will on your consciense lie.

Enter CICELY, SPIGOT, all the Serving-men, and JENKIN, as newly come out of bed.

All. Oh, mistress, mistress! What have you done, mistress?

Nich. 'Sblood, what a caterwauling keep you here!

Jen. O Lord, mistress, how comes this to pass? My master is run away in his shirt, and never so much as call'd me to bring his clothes after him.

Mrs. F. See what guilt is! Here stand I in this place,
Asham'd to look my servants in the face.

Enter FRANKFORD and CRANWELL; whom seeing, she falls on her kneees.

Frank. My words are regist'red in Heaven already.
With patience hear me! I 'll not martyr thee,
Nor mark thee for a strumpet; but with usage
Of more humility torment thy soul,
And kill thee even with kindness.

Cran. Master Frankford - - - Frank. Good Master Cranwell! - Woman, hear thy judgment!
Go make thee ready in thy best attire;
Take with thee all thy gowns, all thy apparel;
Leave nothing that did ever call thee mistress,
Or by whose sight, being left here in the house,
I may remember such a woman by.
Choose thee a bed and hangings for thy chamber;
Take with thee every thing which hath thy mark,
And get thee to my manor seven mile off,
Where live; - 't is thine; I freely give it thee.
My tenants by[2913] shall furnish thee with wains
To carry all thy stuff within two hours;
No longer will I limit[2914] thee my sight.
Choose which of all my servants thou lik'st best,
And they are thine to attend thee.

Mrs. F. A mild sentence.

Frank. But, as thou hop'st for Heaven, as thou believ'st
Thy name' s recorded in the book of life,
I charge thee never after this sad day
To see me, or to meet me; or to send,
By word or writing, gift or otherwise,
To move me, by thyself, or by thy friends;
Nor challenge any part in my two children.
So farewell, Nan; for we will henceforth be
As we had never seen, ne'er more shall see.

Mrs. F. How full my heart is, in mine eyes appears;
What wants in words, I will supply in tears.

Frank. Come, take your coach, your stuff; all must along.
Servants and all make ready; all begone!
It was thy hand cut two hearts out of one. [Exeunt.]

[ACT V]

[SCENE I.][2915]

Enter SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD, gentleman-like, and his Sister, gentlewoman-like.

Susan. Brother, why have you trick'd[2916] me like a bride,
Bought me this gay attire, these ornaments?
Forget you our estate, our poverty?

Sir C. Call me not brother, but imagine me
Some barbarous outlaw, or uncivil kern;[2917]
For if thou shutt'st thine eye, and only hear'st
The words that I shall utter, thou shalt judge me
Some staring ruffian, not thy brother Charles.
Oh, sister! - - Susan. Oh, brother! what doth this strange language mean?

Sir C. Dost love me, sister? Wouldst thou see me live
A bankrupt beggar in the world's disgrace,
And die indebted to mine enemies?
Wouldst thou behold me stand like a huge beam
In the world's eye, a bye-word and a scorn?
It lies in thee of these to acquit me free,
And all my debt I may outstrip by thee.

Susan. By me? Why, I have nothing, nothing left;
I owe even for the clothes upon my back;
I am not worth - - Sir C. O sister, say not so!
It lies in you my downcast state to raise;
To make me stand on even points with the world.
Come, sister, you are rich; indeed you are,
And in your power you have, without delay
Acton's five hundred pounds back to repay.

Susan. Till now I had thought you lov'd me. By my honour
(Which I have kept as spotless as the moon),
I ne'er was mistress of that single doit[2918]
Which I reserv'd not to supply your wants;
And do you think that I would hoard from you?
Now, by my hopes in Heaven, knew I the means
To buy you from the slavery of your debts
(Especially from Acton, whom I hate),
I would redeem it with my life or blood!

Sir C. I challenge it, and, kindred set apart,
Thus, ruffian-like, I lay siege to thy heart.
What do I owe to Acton?

Susan. Why, some five hundred pounds; towards which, I swear,
In all the world I have not one denier.[2919]

Sir C. It will not prove so. Sister, now resolve[2920] me:
What do you think (and speak your conscience)
Would Acton give, might he enjoy your bed?

Susan. He would not shrink to spend a thousand pound
To give the Mountfords' name so deep a wound.

Sir C. A thousand pound! I but five hundred owe:
Grant him your bed; he's paid with interest so.

Susan. Oh, brother!

Sir C. Oh, sister! only this one way,
With that rich jewel you my debts may pay.
In speaking this my cold heart shakes with shame;
Nor do I woo you in a brother's name,
But in a stranger's. Shall I die in debt
To Acton, my grand foe, and you still wear
The precious jewel that he holds so dear?

Susan. My honour I esteem as dear and precious
As my redemption.

Sir C. I esteem you, sister,
As dear, for so dear prizing it.

Susan. Will Charles
Have me cut off my hands, and send them Acton?
Rip up my breast, and with my bleeding heart
Present him as a token?

Sir C. Neither, sister;
But hear me in my strange assertion!
Thy honour and my soul are equal in my regard;
Nor will thy brother Charles survive thy shame.
His kindness, like a burden, hath surcharg'd me,
And under his good deeds I stooping go,
Not with an upright soul. Had I remain'd
In prison still, there doubtless I had died.
Then, unto him that freed me from that prison,
Still do I owe this life. What mov'd my foe
To enfranchise me? 'T was, sister, for your love;
With full five hundred pounds he bought your love; -
And shall he not enjoy it? Shall the weight
Of all this heavy burden lean on me,
And will not you bear part? You did partake
The joy of my release; will you not stand
In joint-bond bound to satisfy the debt?
Shall I be only charg'd?

Susan. But that I know
These arguments come from an honour'd mind,
As in your most extremity of need
Scorning to stand in debt to one you hate, - Nay, rather would engage your unsustain'd honour,
Than to be held ingrate, - I should condemn you.
I see your resolution, and assent;
So Charles will have me, and I am content.

Sir C. For this I trick'd[2921] you up.

Susan. But here 's a knife,
To save mine honour, shall slice out my life.

Sir C. I know thou pleasest me a thousand times
More in that resolution than thy grant. - Observe her love; to soothe it to my suit,
Her honour she will hazard, though not lose;
To bring me out of debt, her rigorous hand
Will pierce her heart, - O wonder! - that will choose,
Rather than stain her blood, her life to lose.
Come, you sad sister to a woful brother,

This is the gate. I 'll bear him such a present,
Such an acquittance for the knight to seal,
As will amaze his senses, and surprise
With admiration all his fantasies.

Enter SIR FRANCIS ACTON and MALBY.

Susan. Before his unchaste thoughts shall seize on me,
'T is here shall my imprison'd soul set free.

Sir F. How! Mountford with his sister, hand in hand!
What miracle's afoot?

Mal. It is a sight
Begets in me much admiration.[2922]

Sir C. Stand not amaz'd to see me thus attended!
Acton, I owe thee money, and, being unable
To bring thee the full sum in ready coin,
Lo! for thy more assurance, here's a pawn, - My sister, my dear sister, whose chaste honour
I prize above a million. Here! Nay, take her;
She's worth your money, man; do not forsake her.

Sir F. I would he were in earnest!

Susan. Impute it not to my immodesty.
My brother, being rich in nothing else
But in his interest that he hath in me,
According to his poverty hath brought you
Me, all his store; whom, howsoe'er you prize,
As forfeit to your hand, he values highly,
And would not sell, but to acquit your debt,
For any emperor's ransom.

Sir F. Stern heart, relent,
Thy former cruelty at length repent!
Was ever known, in any former age,
Such honourable, wrested courtesy?
Lands, honours, life, and all the world forego,
Rather than stand engag'd to such a foe!

Sir C. Acton, she is too poor to be thy bride,
And I too much oppos'd to be thy brother.
There, take her to thee; if thou hast the heart
To seize her as a rape, or lustful prey;
To blur our house, that never yet was stain'd;
To murder her that never meant thee harm;
To kill me now, whom once thou sav'dst from death: -

Do them at once; on her all these rely,
And perish with her spotless chastity.

Sir F. You overcome me in your love, Sir Charles.
I cannot be so cruel to a lady
I love so dearly. Since you have not spar'd
To engage your reputation to the world,
Your sister's honour, which you prize so dear,
Nay, all the comforts which you hold on earth,
To grow out of my debt, being your foe, - Your honour'd thoughts, lo! thus I recompense.
Your metamorphos'd foe receives your gift
In satisfaction of all former wrongs.
This jewel I will wear here in my heart;
And where before I thought her, for her wants,
Too base to be my bride, to end all strife,
I seal you my dear brother, her my wife.

Susan. You still exceed us. I will yield to fate,
And learn to love, where I till now did hate.

Sir C. With that enchantment you have charm'd my soul
And made me rich even in those very words!
I pay no debt, but am indebted more;
Rich in your love, I never can be poor.

Sir F. All's mine is yours; we are alike in state;
Let's knit in love what was oppos'd in hate!
Come, for our nuptials we will straight provide,
Blest only in our brother and fair bride. [Exeunt.]

[SCENE II.][2923]

Enter CRANWELL, FRANKFORD, and NICHOLAS.

Cran. Why do you search each room about your house,
Now that you have despatch'd your wife away?

Frank. Oh, sir! To see that nothing may be left
That ever was my wife's. I lov'd her dearly;
And when I do but think of her unkindness,
My thoughts are all in hell; to avoid which torment,
I would not have a bodkin or a cuff,
A bracelet, necklace, or rabato wire,[2924]
Nor anything that ever was call'd hers,
Left me, by which I might remember her. -
Seek round about.

Nich. 'Sblood! master, here's her lute flung in a corner.

Frank. Her lute! Oh, God! Upon this instrument
Her fingers have rung quick division,[2925]
Sweeter than that which now divides our hearts.
These frets have made me pleasant,[2926] that have now
Frets of my heart-strings made. Oh, Master Cranwell,
Oft hath she made this melancholy wood
(Now mute and dumb for her disastrous chance)
Speak sweetly many a note, sound many a strain
To her own ravishing voice; which being well strung,
What pleasant strange airs have they jointly sung! - Post with it after her! - Now nothing's left;
Of her and hers I am at once bereft.

Nich. I'll ride and overtake her; do my message,
And come back again. [Exit.]

Cran. Meantime, sir, if you please,
I'll to Sir Francis Acton, and inform him
Of what hath past betwixt you and his sister.

Frank. Do as you please. - How ill am I bested,
To be a widower ere my wife be dead! [Exeunt.]

[SCENE III.][2927]

Enter MISTRESS FRANKFORD; with JENKIN, her maid CICELY, her
Coachmen, and three Carters.

Mrs. F. Bid my coach stay! Why should I ride in state,
Being hurl'd so low down by the hand of fate?
A seat like to my fortunes let me have, - Earth for my chair, and for my bed a grave!

Jen. Comfort, good mistress; you have watered your coach with
tears already. You have but two miles now to go to your manor. A
man cannot say by my old master Frankford as he may say by me, that
he wants manors; for he hath three or four, of which this is one that
we are going to now.

Cic. Good mistress, be of good cheer! Sorrow, you see, hurts you,
but helps you not; we all mourn to see you so sad.

Carter. Mistress, I spy one of my landlord's men
Come riding post: 't is like he brings some news.

Mrs. F. Comes he from Master Frankford, he is welcome;
So is his news, because they come from him.

Enter NICHOLAS.

Nich. There!

Mrs. F. I know the lute. Oft have I sung to thee;
We both are out of tune, both out of time.

Nich. Would that had been the worst instrument that e'er you played on! My master commends him to ye; there's all he can find was ever yours; he hath nothing left that ever you could lay claim to but his own heart, - and he could afford you that! All that I have to deliver you is this: he prays you to forget him; and so he bids you farewell.

Mrs. F. I thank him; he is kind, and ever was.
All you that have true feeling of my grief,
That know my loss, and have relenting hearts,
Gird me about, and help me with your tears
To wash my spotted sins! My lute shall groan;
It cannot weep, but shall lament my moan. [She plays.]

Enter WENDOLL [behind].

Wen. Pursu'd with horror of a guilty soul,
And with the sharp scourge of repentance lash'd,
I fly from mine own shadow. O my stars!
What have my parents in their lives deserv'd,
That you should lay this penance on their son?
When I but think of Master Frankford's love,
And lay it to my treason, or compare
My murdering him for his relieving me,
It strikes a terror like a lightning's flash,
To scorch my blood up. Thus I, like the owl,
Asham'd of day, live in these shadowy woods,
Afraid of every leaf or murmuring blast,
Yet longing to receive some perfect knowledge
How he hath dealt with her.
[Seeing MISTRESS FRANKFORD.] O my sad fate!
Here, and so far from home, and thus attended!
Oh, God! I have divorc'd the truest turtles
That ever liv'd together, and, being divided,
In several places make their several moan;
She in the fields laments, and he at home;
So poets write that Orpheus made the trees
And stones to dance to his melodious harp,
Meaning the rustic and the barbarous hinds,
That had no understanding part in them:

So she from these rude carters tears extracts,
Making their flinty hearts with grief to rise,
And draw down rivers from their rocky eyes.

Mrs. F. [to NICHOLAS.] If you return unto my master, say
(Though not from me, for I am all unworthy
To blast his name so with a strumpet's tongue)
That you have seen me weep, wish myself dead!
Nay, you may say, too (for my vow is past),[2928]
Last night you saw me eat and drink my last.
This to your master you may say and swear;
For it is writ in heaven, and decreed here.

Nich. I'll say you wept; I'll swear you made me sad.
Why, how now, eyes? What now? What's here to do?
I'm gone, or I shall straight turn baby too.

Wen. [Aside.] I cannot weep, my heart is all on fire.
Curs'd be the fruits of my unchaste desire!

Mrs. F. Go, break this lute upon my coach's wheel,
As the last music that I e'er shall make, - Not as my husband's gift, but my farewell
To all earth's joy; and so your master tell!

Nich. If I can for crying.

Wen. [Aside.] Grief, have done,
Or, like a madman, I shall frantic run.

Mrs. F. You have beheld the wofull'st wretch on earth, - A woman made of tears; would you had words
To express but what you see! My inward grief
No tongue can utter; yet unto your power
You may describe my sorrow, and disclose
To thy sad master my abundant woes.

Nich. I'll do your commendations.[2929]

Mrs. F. Oh, no!
I dare not so presume; nor to my children!
I am disclaim'd in both; alas! I am.
Oh, never teach them, when they come to speak,
To name the name of mother: chide their tongue,
If they by chance light on that hated word;
Tell them 't is naught; for when that word they name,
Poor, pretty souls! they harp on their own shame.

Wen. [Aside.] To recompense their wrongs, what canst thou do?
Thou hast made her husbandless, and childless too.

Mrs. F. I have no more to say. - Speak not for me;
Yet you may tell your master what you see.

Nich. I'll do 't. Exit.

Wen. [Aside.] I'll speak to her, and comfort her in grief.
Oh, but her wound cannot be cur'd with words!
No matter, though; I'll do my best, good will
To work a cure on her whom I did kill.

Mrs. F. So, now unto my coach, then to my home,
So to my death-bed; for from this sad hour,
I never will nor eat, nor drink, nor taste
Of any cates[2930] that may preserve my life.
I never will nor smile, nor sleep, nor rest;
But when my tears have wash'd my black soul white,
Sweet Saviour, to thy hands I yield my sprite.

Wen. [coming forward.] Oh, Mistress Frankford!

Mrs. F. Oh, for God's sake, fly!
The devil doth come to tempt me, ere I die.
My coach! - This sin, that with an angel's face
Conjur'd[2931] mine honour, till he sought my wrack,
In my repentant eye seems ugly, black.

Exeunt all [except WENDOLL and JENKIN]; the Carters whistling.

Jen. What, my young master, that fled in his shirt! How come you by your clothes again? You have made our house in a sweet pickle, ha' ye not, think you? What, shall I serve you still, or cleave to the old house?

Wen. Hence, slave! Away, with thy unseason'd mirth!
Unless thou canst shed tears, and sigh, and howl,
Curse thy sad fortunes, and exclaim on fate,
Thou art not for my turn.

Jen. Marry, an you will not, another will; farewell, and be hang'd!
Would you had never come to have kept this coil[2932] within our doors! We shall ha' you run away like a sprite again. [Exit.]

Wen. She 's gone to death; I live to want and woe,
Her life, her sins, and all upon my head.
And I must now go wander, like a Cain,
In foreign countries and remoted climes,
Where the report of my ingratitude

Cannot be heard. I 'll over first to France,
And so to Germany and Italy;
Where, when I have recovered, and by travel
Gotten those perfect tongues,[2933] and that these rumours
May in their height abate, I will return:
And I divine (however now dejected),
My worth and parts being by some great man prais'd,
At my return I may in court be rais'd. Exit.

[SCENE IV.][2934]

Enter SIR FRANCIS ACTON, SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD, CRANWELL, [MALBY,] and SUSAN.

Sir F. Brother, and now my wife, I think these troubles,
Fall on my head by justice of the heavens,
For being so strict to you in your extremities;
But we are now aton'd. I would my sister
Could with like happiness o'ercome her griefs
As we have ours.

Susan. You tell us, Master Cranwell, wondrous things
Touching the patience of that gentleman,
With what strange virtue he demeans[2935] his grief.

Cran. I told you what I was a witness of;
It was my fortune to lodge there that night.

Sir F. Oh, that same villain, Wendoll! 'T was his tongue
That did corrupt her; she was of herself
Chaste and devoted well.[2936] Is this the house?

Cran. Yes, sir; I take it, here your sister lies.[2937]

Sir F. My brother Frankford show'd too mild a spirit
In the revenge of such a loathed crime.
Less than he did, no man of spirit could do.
I am so far from blaming his revenge,
That I commend it. Had it been my case,
Their souls at once had from their breasts been freed;
Death to such deeds of shame is the due meed.

Enter JENKIN and CICELY.

Jen. Oh, my mistress, mistress! my poor mistress!

Cicely. Alas! that ever I was born; what shall I do for my

poor mistress?

Sir C. Why, what of her?

Jen. Oh, Lord, sir! she no sooner heard that her brother and her friends had come to see how she did, but she, for very shame of her guilty conscience, fell into such a swoon, that we had much ado to get life in her.

Susan. Alas, that she should bear so hard a fate!
Pity it is repentance comes too late.

Sir F. Is she so weak in body?

Jen. Oh, sir! I can assure you there 's no hope of life in her; for she will take no sust'nance: she hath plainly starv'd herself, and now she 's as lean as a lath. She ever looks for the good hour. Many gentlemen and gentlewomen of the country are come to comfort her.

[SCENE V.][2938]

[SIR CHARLES MOUNTFORD, SIR FRANCIS ACTON, MALBY, CRANWELL, and SUSAN.]

Enter MISTRESS FRANKFORD in her bed.

Mal. How fare you, Mistress Frankford?

Mrs. F. Sick, sick, oh, sick! Give me some air, I pray you!
Tell me, oh, tell me, where is Master Frankford?
Will not he deign to see me ere I die?

Mal. Yes, Mistress Frankford; divers gentlemen,
Your loving neighbours, with that just request
Have mov'd, and told him of your weak estate:[2939]
Who, though with much ado to get belief,
Examining of the general circumstance,
Seeing your sorrow and your penitence,
And hearing therewithal the great desire
You have to see him, ere you left the world,
He gave to us his faith to follow us,
And sure he will be here immediately.

Mrs. F. You have half reviv'd me with the pleasing news,
Raise me a little higher in my bed. - Blush I not, brother Acton? Blush I not, Sir Charles?
Can you not read my fault writ, in my cheek?
Is not my crime there? Tell me, gentlemen.

Sir C. Alas, good mistress, sickness hath not left you
Blood in your face enough to make you blush.

Mrs. F. Then, sickness, like a friend, my fault would hide. - Is my husband come? My soul but tarries
His arrive; then I am fit for heaven.

Sir F. I came to chide you, but my words of hate
Are turn'd to pity and compassionate grief.
I came to rate you, but my brawls, you see,
Melt into tears, and I must weep by thee. - Here's Master Frankford now.

Enter FRANKFORD.

Frank. Good morrow, brother; morrow, gentlemen!
God, that hath laid this cross upon our heads,
Might (had He pleas'd) have made our cause of meeting
On a more fair and more contented ground;
But He that made us made us to this woe.

Mrs. F. And is he come? Methinks, that voice I know.

Frank. How do you, woman?

Mrs. F. Well, Master Frankford, well; but shall be better,
I hope within this hour. Will you vouchsafe,
Out of your grace and your humanity,
To take a spotted strumpet by the hand?

Frank. This hand once held my heart in faster bonds,
Than now 'tis gripp'd by me. God pardon them
That made us first break hold!

Mrs. F. Amen, amen!
Out of my zeal to Heaven, whither I'm now bound,
I was so impudent to wish you here;
And once more beg your pardon. O, good man,
And father to my children, pardon me.
Pardon, oh, pardon me: my fault so heinous is,
That if you in this world forgive it not,
Heaven will not clear it in the world to come.
Faintness hath so usurp'd upon my knees,
That kneel I cannot; but on my heart's knees
My prostrate soul lies thrown down at your feet,
To beg your gracious pardon. Pardon, oh, pardon me!

Frank. As freely, from the low depth of my soul,
As my Redeemer hath forgiven His death,

I pardon thee. I will shed tears for thee; pray with thee;
And, in mere pity of thy weak estate,
I'll wish to die with thee.

All. So do we all.

Nich. So will not I;
I'll sigh and sob, but, by my faith, not die.

Sir F. Oh, Master Frankford, all the near alliance
I lose by her, shall be suppli'd in thee.
You are my brother by the nearest way;
Her kindred hath fall'n off, but yours doth stay.

Frank. Even as I hope for pardon, at that day
When the Great Judge of heaven in scarlet sits,
So be thou pardon'd! Though thy rash offence
Divorc'd our bodies, thy repentant tears
Unite our souls.

Sir C. Then comfort, Mistress Frankford!
You see your husband hath forgiven your fall;
Then rouse your spirits, and cheer your fainting soul!

Susan. How is it with you?

Sir F. How d' ye feel yourself?

Mrs. F. Not of this world.

Frank. I see you are not. and I weep to see it.
My wife, the mother to my pretty babes!
Both those lost names I do restore thee back,
And with this kiss I wed thee once again.
Though thou art wounded in thy honour'd name,
And with that grief upon thy death-bed liest,
Honest in heart, upon my soul, thou diest.

Mrs. F. Pardon'd on earth, soul, thou in heaven art free;
Once more thy wife, dies thus embracing thee.[2940] [Dies.]

Frank. New-married, and new-widow'd. - Oh! she's dead.
And a cold grave must be her nuptial bed.

Sir C. Sir, be of good comfort, and your heavy sorrow
Part equally amongst us; storms divided
Abate their force, and with less rage are guided.

Cran. Do. Master Frankford; he that hath least part,
Will find enough to drown one troubled heart.

Sir. F. Peace with thee, Nan! - Brothers and gentlemen,
All we that can plead interest in her grief,
Bestow upon her body funeral tears!
Brother, had you with threats and usage bad
Punish'd her sin, the grief of her offence
Had not with such true sorrow touch'd her heart.

Frank. I see it had not; therefore, on her grave
Will I bestow this funeral epitaph,
Which on her marble tomb shall be engrav'd,
In golden letters shall these words be fill'd:[2941]
Here lies she whom her husband's kindness kill'd.

THE EPILOGUE

An honest crew, disposed to be merry,
Came to a tavern by, and call'd for wine.
The drawer brought it, smiling like a cherry,
And told them it was pleasant, neat[2942] and fine.
'Taste it,' quoth one. He did so. 'Fie!' (quoth he)
'This wine was good; now 't runs too near the lee.'

Another sipp'd, to give the wine his due,
And said unto the rest, it drunk too flat;
The third said, it was old; the fourth, too new;
Nay, quoth the fifth, the sharpness likes me not.
Thus, gentlemen, you see how, in one hour,
The wine was new, old, flat, sharp, sweet, and sour.

Unto this wine we do allude[2943] our play,
Which some will judge too trivial, some too grave:
You as our guests we entertain this day,
And bid you welcome to the best we have.
Excuse us, then; good wine may be disgrac'd,
When every several mouth hath sundry taste.

NOTES ON THIS TEXT

[2802] Defeat.

[2803] Room in Frankford's house.

[2804] Q Acton.

[2805] The Shaking of the Sheets, or The Dance of Death, was a well-known ballad and dance tune.

[2806] Gained the dignity.

[2807] In preparation for marrying.

[2808] Reduces her to submission.

[2809] The points where the strings of a musical instrument are stopped.

[2810] Streamers.

[2811] Boisterous.

[2812] Q¹ But.

[2813] Gold coins worth about $2.50.

[2814] Shake hands on it.

[2815] Yard of the same.

[2816] Frolic, bout.

[2817] The names of the dance-tunes here were all familiar.

[2818] Chevy Chase.

[2819] On the descent.

[2820] Pluck.

[2821] Call back.

[2822] Verity explains as "booty," but apparently it is the same as jesses.

[2823] Leg-straps.

[2824] Quarry: "the swoop upon the bird." (N. E. D.)

[2825] Not satisfactorily explained.

[2826] Attacked afresh.

[2827] Toes.

[2828] Unexplained.

[2829] The rest of the speech seems to refer to Mountford's hawk.

[2830] Bungler.

[2831] Curly-tailed.

[2832] Limit of liability.

[2833] Abundantly.

[2834] Arrest.

[2835] Overflows

[2836] Have made good progress.

[2837] Splashed.

[2838] Versed.

[2839] Forming factions.

[2840] Judged.

[2841] Resources.

[2842] Accomplishments.

[2843] Grieves.

[2844] Use.

[2845] The Gaol.

[2846] Changed.

[2847] To prevent failure.

[2848] Feeble.

[2849] Paid over.

[2850] Frankford's house.

[2851] Conceive.

[2852] Foolish.

[2853] Relationship.

[2854] Opprobrious.

[2855] Acquire, add.

[2856] Secret proceedings.

[2857] Sneaking.

[2858] Sir Charles Mountford's house.

[2859] Interest.

[2860] Extremely rigorously.

[2861] List. Properly a list of names to be prayed for.

[2862] Ed. conj. tyrannous.

[2863] Of the debtor's prison.

[2864] Legal transactions.

[2865] Frankford's house.

[2866] Tray for removing dishes.

[2867] Table-cover.

[2868] Small logs.

[2869] Await.

[2870] Economist.

[2871] Maker of quarrels.

[2872] Evidence.

[2873] Resentment.

[2874] Of noble origin.

[2875] Avoid.

[2876] Pack.

[2877] Well done.

[2878] Be my partner.

[2879] Be their opponents.

[2880] A game like cribbage.

[2881] An earlier kind of whist.

[2882] Be shut out.

[2883] Cut.

[2884] Pack.

[2885] This line should probably be given to Mrs. F. If not, Cranwell exit here with Jenkin.

[2886] Old Mountford's house.

[2887] Rioting.

[2888] York Castle.

[2889] Ceased.

[2890] Joyful.

[2891] Too base in their conduct. (Ward.)

[2892] Ed. conj. Qq. in.

[2893] Lose.

[2894] Weigh impartially.

[2895] Verity emends to expectation.

[2896] Frankford's house.

[2897] Influence with.

[2898] Less severe.

[2899] Good fellow.

[2900] Armed.

[2901] Cause discomfort to.

[2902] Intimacy.

[2903] Another part of the house.

[2904] Outside the house.

[2905] Bow-shots.

[2906] The hall of the house. Note that in the Qq. these scenes are continuous.

[2907] Delay.

[2908] Established his case. (Ward.)

[2909] Count backwards.

[2910] Dressing-gown.

[2911] Outcast.

[2912] Rank.

[2913] Nearby.

[2914] Permit.

[2915] Before Sir Francis Acton's house.

[2916] Dressed.

[2917] A Celtic foot-soldier; often used in contempt.

[2918] A small coin.

[2919] Penny.

[2920] Tell.

[2921] Dressed finely.

[2922] Wonder.

[2923] Frankford's house.

[2924] Wire used to support a ruff.

[2925] Variation.

[2926] Merry.

[2927] Road near Mistress Frankford's manor.

[2928] Sworn.

[2929] Commands.

[2930] Food.

[2931] Enchanted, seduced.

[2932] Made this trouble.

[2933] Acquired these languages perfectly.

[2934] Before the Manor House.

[2935] Conducts.

[2936] Dutiful.

[2937] Dwells.

[2938] The Manor Home. The scene was really unchanged.

[2939] Condition.

[2940] Verity suggests, Once more (i. e. Kiss me once more); thy wife dies, etc.

[2941] Cut and filled in with gold.

[2942] Pure.

[2943] Compare.

*** END OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK THE CHIEF ELIZABETHAN DRAMATISTS, EXCLUDING SHAKESPEARE ***

Updated editions will replace the previous one - the old editions will
be renamed.

Creating the works from print editions not protected by U.S. copyright

law means that no one owns a United States copyright in these works, so the Foundation (and you!) can copy and distribute it in the United States without permission and without paying copyright royalties. Special rules, set forth in the General Terms of Use part of this license, apply to copying and distributing Project Gutenberg electronic works to protect the PROJECT GUTENBERG concept and trademark. Project Gutenberg is a registered trademark, and may not be used if you charge for an eBook, except by following the terms of the trademark license, including paying royalties for use of the Project Gutenberg trademark. If you do not charge anything for copies of this eBook, complying with the trademark license is very easy. You may use this eBook for nearly any purpose such as creation of derivative works, reports, performances and research. Project Gutenberg eBooks may be modified and printed and given away - you may do practically ANYTHING in the United States with eBooks not protected by U.S. copyright law. Redistribution is subject to the trademark license, especially commercial redistribution.

START: FULL LICENSE

THE FULL PROJECT GUTENBERG LICENSE

PLEASE READ THIS BEFORE YOU DISTRIBUTE OR USE THIS WORK

To protect the Project Gutenberg mission of promoting the free distribution of electronic works, by using or distributing this work (or any other work associated in any way with the phrase "Project Gutenberg"), you agree to comply with all the terms of the Full Project Gutenberg License available with this file or online at www.gutenberg.org/license.

Section 1. General Terms of Use and Redistributing Project Gutenberg electronic works

1.A. By reading or using any part of this Project Gutenberg electronic work, you indicate that you have read, understand, agree to and accept all the terms of this license and intellectual property (trademark/copyright) agreement. If you do not agree to abide by all the terms of this agreement, you must cease using and return or destroy all copies of Project Gutenberg electronic works in your possession. If you paid a fee for obtaining a copy of or access to a Project Gutenberg electronic work and you do not agree to be bound by the terms of this agreement, you may obtain a refund from the person or entity to whom you paid the fee as set forth in paragraph 1.E.8.

1.B. "Project Gutenberg" is a registered trademark. It may only be used on or associated in any way with an electronic work by people who agree to be bound by the terms of this agreement. There are a few things that you can do with most Project Gutenberg electronic works even without complying with the full terms of this agreement. See paragraph 1.C below. There are a lot of things you can do with Project Gutenberg electronic works if you follow the terms of this agreement and help preserve free future access to Project Gutenberg electronic works. See paragraph 1.E below.

1.C. The Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation ("the Foundation" or PGLAF), owns a compilation copyright in the collection of Project Gutenberg electronic works. Nearly all the individual works in the collection are in the public domain in the United States. If an individual work is unprotected by copyright law in the United States and you are located in the United States, we do not claim a right to prevent you from copying, distributing, performing, displaying or creating derivative works based on the work as long as all references to Project Gutenberg are removed. Of course, we hope that you will support the Project Gutenberg mission of promoting free access to electronic works by freely sharing Project Gutenberg works in compliance with the terms of this agreement for keeping the Project Gutenberg name associated with the work. You can easily comply with the terms of this agreement by keeping this work in the same format with its attached full Project Gutenberg License when you share it without charge with others.

1.D. The copyright laws of the place where you are located also govern what you can do with this work. Copyright laws in most countries are in a constant state of change. If you are outside the United States, check the laws of your country in addition to the terms of this agreement before downloading, copying, displaying, performing, distributing or creating derivative works based on this work or any other Project Gutenberg work. The Foundation makes no representations concerning the copyright status of any work in any country other than the United States.

1.E. Unless you have removed all references to Project Gutenberg:

1.E.1. The following sentence, with active links to, or other immediate access to, the full Project Gutenberg License must appear prominently whenever any copy of a Project Gutenberg work (any work on which the phrase "Project Gutenberg" appears, or with which the phrase "Project Gutenberg" is associated) is accessed, displayed, performed, viewed, copied or distributed:

This eBook is for the use of anyone anywhere in the United States and most other parts of the world at no cost and with almost no restrictions whatsoever. You may copy it, give it away or re-use it under the terms of the Project Gutenberg License included with this eBook or online at www.gutenberg.org. If you
are not located in the United States, you will have to check the laws of the country where you are located before using this eBook.

1.E.2. If an individual Project Gutenberg electronic work is derived from texts not protected by U.S. copyright law (does not contain a notice indicating that it is posted with permission of the copyright holder), the work can be copied and distributed to anyone in the United States without paying any fees or charges. If you are redistributing or providing access to a work with the phrase "Project Gutenberg" associated with or appearing on the work, you must comply either with the requirements of paragraphs 1.E.1 through 1.E.7 or obtain permission for the use of the work and the Project Gutenberg trademark as set forth in paragraphs 1.E.8 or 1.E.9.

1.E.3. If an individual Project Gutenberg electronic work is posted with the permission of the copyright holder, your use and distribution must comply with both paragraphs 1.E.1 through 1.E.7 and any additional terms imposed by the copyright holder. Additional terms will be linked to the Project Gutenberg License for all works posted with the permission of the copyright holder found at the beginning of this work.

1.E.4. Do not unlink or detach or remove the full Project Gutenberg License terms from this work, or any files containing a part of this work or any other work associated with Project Gutenberg.

1.E.5. Do not copy, display, perform, distribute or redistribute this electronic work, or any part of this electronic work, without prominently displaying the sentence set forth in paragraph 1.E.1 with active links or immediate access to the full terms of the Project Gutenberg License.

1.E.6. You may convert to and distribute this work in any binary, compressed, marked up, nonproprietary or proprietary form, including any word processing or hypertext form. However, if you provide access to or distribute copies of a Project Gutenberg work in a format other than "Plain Vanilla ASCII" or other format used in the official version posted on the official Project Gutenberg website (www.gutenberg.org), you must, at no additional cost, fee or expense to the user, provide a copy, a means of exporting a copy, or a means of obtaining a copy upon request, of the work in its original "Plain Vanilla ASCII" or other form. Any alternate format must include the full Project Gutenberg License as specified in paragraph 1.E.1.

1.E.7. Do not charge a fee for access to, viewing, displaying, performing, copying or distributing any Project Gutenberg works unless you comply with paragraph 1.E.8 or 1.E.9.

1.E.8. You may charge a reasonable fee for copies of or providing

access to or distributing Project Gutenberg electronic works provided that:

- You pay a royalty fee of 20% of the gross profits you derive from the use of Project Gutenberg works calculated using the method you already use to calculate your applicable taxes. The fee is owed to the owner of the Project Gutenberg trademark, but he has agreed to donate royalties under this paragraph to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation. Royalty payments must be paid within 60 days following each date on which you prepare (or are legally required to prepare) your periodic tax returns. Royalty payments should be clearly marked as such and sent to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation at the address specified in Section 4, "Information about donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation."

- You provide a full refund of any money paid by a user who notifies you in writing (or by e-mail) within 30 days of receipt that s/he does not agree to the terms of the full Project Gutenberg License. You must require such a user to return or destroy all copies of the works possessed in a physical medium and discontinue all use of and all access to other copies of Project Gutenberg works.

- You provide, in accordance with paragraph 1.F.3, a full refund of any money paid for a work or a replacement copy, if a defect in the electronic work is discovered and reported to you within 90 days of receipt of the work.

- You comply with all other terms of this agreement for free distribution of Project Gutenberg works.

1.E.9. If you wish to charge a fee or distribute a Project Gutenberg electronic work or group of works on different terms than are set forth in this agreement, you must obtain permission in writing from the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, the manager of the Project Gutenberg trademark. Contact the Foundation as set forth in Section 3 below.

1.F.

1.F.1. Project Gutenberg volunteers and employees expend considerable effort to identify, do copyright research on, transcribe and proofread works not protected by U.S. copyright law in creating the Project Gutenberg collection. Despite these efforts, Project Gutenberg electronic works, and the medium on which they may be stored, may contain "Defects," such as, but not limited to, incomplete, inaccurate or corrupt data, transcription errors, a copyright or other intellectual property infringement, a defective or damaged disk or other medium, a computer virus, or computer codes that damage or cannot be read by your equipment.

1.F.2. LIMITED WARRANTY, DISCLAIMER OF DAMAGES - Except for the "Right of Replacement or Refund" described in paragraph 1.F.3, the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, the owner of the Project Gutenberg trademark, and any other party distributing a Project Gutenberg electronic work under this agreement, disclaim all liability to you for damages, costs and expenses, including legal fees. YOU AGREE THAT YOU HAVE NO REMEDIES FOR NEGLIGENCE, STRICT LIABILITY, BREACH OF WARRANTY OR BREACH OF CONTRACT EXCEPT THOSE PROVIDED IN PARAGRAPH 1.F.3. YOU AGREE THAT THE FOUNDATION, THE TRADEMARK OWNER, AND ANY DISTRIBUTOR UNDER THIS AGREEMENT WILL NOT BE LIABLE TO YOU FOR ACTUAL, DIRECT, INDIRECT, CONSEQUENTIAL, PUNITIVE OR INCIDENTAL DAMAGES EVEN IF YOU GIVE NOTICE OF THE POSSIBILITY OF SUCH DAMAGE.

1.F.3. LIMITED RIGHT OF REPLACEMENT OR REFUND - If you discover a defect in this electronic work within 90 days of receiving it, you can receive a refund of the money (if any) you paid for it by sending a written explanation to the person you received the work from. If you received the work on a physical medium, you must return the medium with your written explanation. The person or entity that provided you

with the defective work may elect to provide a replacement copy in lieu of a refund. If you received the work electronically, the person or entity providing it to you may choose to give you a second opportunity to receive the work electronically in lieu of a refund. If the second copy is also defective, you may demand a refund in writing without further opportunities to fix the problem.

1.F.4. Except for the limited right of replacement or refund set forth in paragraph 1.F.3, this work is provided to you 'AS-IS', WITH NO OTHER WARRANTIES OF ANY KIND, EXPRESS OR IMPLIED, INCLUDING BUT NOT LIMITED TO WARRANTIES OF MERCHANTABILITY OR FITNESS FOR ANY PURPOSE.

1.F.5. Some states do not allow disclaimers of certain implied warranties or the exclusion or limitation of certain types of damages. If any disclaimer or limitation set forth in this agreement violates the law of the state applicable to this agreement, the agreement shall be interpreted to make the maximum disclaimer or limitation permitted by the applicable state law. The invalidity or unenforceability of any provision of this agreement shall not void the remaining provisions.

1.F.6. INDEMNITY - You agree to indemnify and hold the Foundation, the trademark owner, any agent or employee of the Foundation, anyone providing copies of Project Gutenberg electronic works in accordance with this agreement, and any volunteers associated with the production, promotion and distribution of Project Gutenberg electronic works, harmless from all liability, costs and expenses, including legal fees, that arise directly or indirectly from any of the following which you do or cause to occur: (a) distribution of this or any Project Gutenberg work, (b) alteration, modification, or additions or deletions to any Project Gutenberg work, and (c) any Defect you cause.

Section 2. Information about the Mission of Project Gutenberg

Project Gutenberg is synonymous with the free distribution of electronic works in formats readable by the widest variety of computers including obsolete, old, middle-aged and new computers. It exists because of the efforts of hundreds of volunteers and donations from people in all walks of life.

Volunteers and financial support to provide volunteers with the assistance they need are critical to reaching Project Gutenberg's goals and ensuring that the Project Gutenberg collection will remain freely available for generations to come. In 2001, the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation was created to provide a secure and permanent future for Project Gutenberg and future generations. To learn more about the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation and how your efforts and donations can help, see Sections 3 and 4 and the Foundation information page at www.gutenberg.org.

Section 3. Information about the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation

The Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation is a non-profit 501(c)(3) educational corporation organized under the laws of the state of Mississippi and granted tax exempt status by the Internal Revenue Service. The Foundation's EIN or federal tax identification number is 64-6221541. Contributions to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation are tax deductible to the full extent permitted by U.S. federal laws and your state's laws.

The Foundation's business office is located at 41 Watchung Plaza #516, Montclair NJ 07042, USA, +1 (862) 621-9288. Email contact links and up to date contact information can be found at the Foundation's website and official page at www.gutenberg.org/contact

Section 4. Information about Donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation

Project Gutenberg depends upon and cannot survive without widespread public support and donations to carry out its mission of increasing the number of public domain and licensed works that can be freely distributed in machine-readable form accessible by the widest

array of equipment including outdated equipment. Many small donations ($1 to $5,000) are particularly important to maintaining tax exempt status with the IRS.

The Foundation is committed to complying with the laws regulating charities and charitable donations in all 50 states of the United States. Compliance requirements are not uniform and it takes a considerable effort, much paperwork and many fees to meet and keep up with these requirements. We do not solicit donations in locations where we have not received written confirmation of compliance. To SEND DONATIONS or determine the status of compliance for any particular state visit www.gutenberg.org/donate.

While we cannot and do not solicit contributions from states where we have not met the solicitation requirements, we know of no prohibition against accepting unsolicited donations from donors in such states who approach us with offers to donate.

International donations are gratefully accepted, but we cannot make any statements concerning tax treatment of donations received from outside the United States. U.S. laws alone swamp our small staff.

Please check the Project Gutenberg web pages for current donation methods and addresses. Donations are accepted in a number of other ways including checks, online payments and credit card donations. To donate, please visit: www.gutenberg.org/donate.

Section 5. General Information About Project Gutenberg electronic works

Professor Michael S. Hart was the originator of the Project Gutenberg concept of a library of electronic works that could be freely shared with anyone. For forty years, he produced and distributed Project Gutenberg eBooks with only a loose network of volunteer support.

Project Gutenberg eBooks are often created from several printed editions, all of which are confirmed as not protected by copyright in the U.S. unless a copyright notice is included. Thus, we do not necessarily keep eBooks in compliance with any particular paper edition.

Most people start at our website which has the main PG search facility: www.gutenberg.org.

This website includes information about Project Gutenberg, including how to make donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, how to help produce our new eBooks, and how to subscribe to our email newsletter to hear about new eBooks.